

The 20-Minute Table

Seventy fast, whole-food recipes for people who want breakfast in ten minutes and dinner in twenty — and who would rather not spend the evening washing up.

70 RECIPES	45 CUISINES	20 MINUTES, MAX	1 PAN OR BASKET
HARISSA CHICKPEA & CAULIFLOWER CRUNCH · MISO-GLAZED SALMON WITH CHARRED TENDERSTEM · PERI-PERI CHICKEN THIGHS WITH BLISTERED PEPPERS · TANDOORI PANEER TIKKA SKEWERS · GOCHUJANG TOFU WITH SMASHED SESAME CUCUMBER · ZA'ATAR CHICKEN WITH LEMON COURGETTE · CHILLI-LIME PRAWNS WITH AVOCADO & CORIANDER · SICILIAN SEA BASS WITH FENNEL, OLIVE & ORANGE · JERK CHICKEN WITH CHARRED PINEAPPLE · SHAWARMA-SPICED TURKEY WITH SUMAC ONIONS · BERBERE SWEET POTATO & LENTIL BOWL · CAJUN BLACKENED COD WITH CHARRED CORN SALSA · FURIKAKE SALMON RICE BOWL · CHERMOULA PRAWNS WITH COURGETTE RIBBONS · SALT & PEPPER TOFU WITH PAK CHOI · PAD KRAPOW — THAI BASIL CHICKEN · QUICK THAI GREEN CURRY PRAWNS · GINGER-GARLIC PRAWN & BROCCOLI STIR-FRY · SICHUAN CUMIN BEEF WITH PEPPERS · KOREAN BULGOGI BEEF BOWL · VIETNAMESE LEMONGRASS CHICKEN BOWL · SHOGAYAKI — JAPANESE GINGER PORK WITH CABBAGE · KERALA COCONUT PRAWN FRY · EGG & SPINACH BHURJI · FIFTEEN-MINUTE CHANA MASALA · TURKISH MENEMEN · GREEN SHAKSHUKA · GREEK LEMON CHICKEN & ORZO · PRAWN SAGANAKI WITH FETA · BROCCOLI AGLIO E OLIO WITH ANCHOVY · TUSCAN WHITE BEAN, KALE & LEMON SKILLET · TUNA PUTTANESCA BEANS · GAMBAS AL AJILLO WITH CHICKPEAS · SMOKY PAPRIKA CHICKEN WITH PIQUILLO PEPPERS · CHIPOTLE BLACK BEAN & CHARRED CORN SKILLET · LOMO SALTADO · MOQUECA EXPRESS — BRAZILIAN COCONUT FISH STEW · FILIPINO ADOBO FLASH CHICKEN · NASI GORENG CAULIFLOWER RICE WITH FRIED EGG · SAMBAL GREEN BEANS WITH EGG · BURMESE GOLDEN TURMERIC CHICKEN · ETHIOPIAN GOMEN WITH SPICED EGGS · RAS EL HANOUT TURKEY WITH HERBS & ALMONDS · WEST AFRICAN PEANUT STEW EXPRESS · GEORGIAN WALNUT-GARLIC GREEN BEANS WITH EGGS · DECONSTRUCTED VIETNAMESE SUMMER ROLL BOWL · FATTOUSH WITH CRISPED CHICKPEAS · SALMON POKE BOWL · PRAWN CEVICHE TOSTADA SALAD · TURKISH ÇOBAN SALAD WITH TUNA & SUMAC · SWEET POTATO, EGG & CHILLI HASH · HALLOUMI, TOMATO & ZA'ATAR PLATE · MASALA OMELETTE MUFFINS · BANANA, OAT & ALMOND BUTTER BAKE · CRISPY CHICKPEA, AVOCADO & LEMON TOAST · TAMAGOYAKI WITH RICE & NORI · GYERAN BAP — KOREAN EGG RICE · TEN-MINUTE GINGER CONGEE · RAVA UTTAPAM WITH COCONUT CHUTNEY · PERSIAN HERB & FETA OMELETTE · HUEVOS RANCHEROS RÁPIDOS · PAN CON TOMATE WITH SOFT EGGS · FUL MEDAMES · BUCKWHEAT GALETTE WITH EGG & GREENS · KHAO TOM — THAI RICE SOUP WITH PRAWNS · EGG & TOMATO STIR-FRY · SINANGAG — FILIPINO GARLIC RICE & EGG · TEN-MINUTE BIRCHER MUESLI · DANISH RYE WITH COTTAGE CHEESE, CUCUMBER & DILL · ORANGE, DATE & ALMOND YOGHURT BOWL			

 20 AIR FRYER

 35 ONE PAN

 7 WOK

 8 NO COOK

Twenty Minutes Is Plenty

Most of what makes cooking slow has nothing to do with cooking. It is the deciding, the shopping, the hunting for a jar of something at the back of a cupboard, and the twenty minutes of washing up that follow a meal that took thirty to make.

So this book removes those parts rather than the good ones. Nothing here is a shortcut version of a longer dish — no simmering-for-an-hour recipe with the hour taken out. These are dishes that were always fast, drawn from the kitchens where fast cooking is not a compromise but the whole tradition: a wok of chicken and holy basil, a basket of cauliflower under harissa, eggs cooked in tomatoes in a pan the size of a dinner plate.

Everything is built on whole ingredients, which is less an ideology than a practical matter: they cook faster than you think, they taste of what they are, and they let you season a dish rather than negotiate with something already seasoned for you. And every recipe was written to leave one pan or one basket behind. That constraint is the reason these end up in the weekly rotation rather than the someday pile.

A word on the timings. They are honest, and they assume a cold start: knife out, nothing chopped, the pan not yet on. They also assume you read the recipe through once before you begin, which for a fifteen-minute dish is less a suggestion than the method itself.

Cook them in any order. Break them freely. The swap notes exist because you will not have everything, and that has never once mattered.



EVERY RECIPE PAGE, WITHOUT EXCEPTION

HOW A PAGE WORKS

- 1 **The ring**
Total time against a twenty-minute dial, so you can see the cost of a recipe before you read it.
- 2 **The number**
Every recipe is numbered once. The contents, the cuisine index and the what-to-cook-when list all point back to it.
- 3 **The panel**
Everything you need, listed in the order you will reach for it, grouped when the dish has two parts.
- 4 **Why it works**
The one piece of technique that makes the dish fast, or good, or both. Read it once; you will not need it again.
- 5 **The strip**
Approximate nutrition for a quarter of the finished dish. Estimates, rounded, and worth exactly what estimates are worth.
- 6 **Washing up**
What you are actually committing to. This is the number that decides whether a recipe gets cooked twice.

The Fast Pantry

Twenty-minute cooking only works when the slow part — the shopping, the searching, the standing in front of an open cupboard — has already happened. Keep the shelves below stocked and any of the seventy recipes in this book becomes a decision rather than a project.

OILS & ACIDS

Extra virgin olive oil for finishing, a neutral high-smoke oil (groundnut or rapeseed) for anything hot, toasted sesame oil, red wine vinegar, rice vinegar. Lemons and limes, always, in quantity.

PASTES & BOTTLES

Rose harissa, gochujang, white miso, Thai green curry paste, sambal oelek, chipotle in adobo, tahini, fish sauce, light and dark soy, mirin, runny honey.

THE FRIDGE

Eggs by the dozen, thick Greek yoghurt, feta, cottage cheese, a knob of ginger, a head of garlic, spring onions, fresh chillies, a bag of spinach, coriander and parsley kept stems-down in water.

FAST CARBOHYDRATE

Cooked rice, always — a batch on Sunday feeds four breakfasts. Orzo, rice noodles, couscous, oats, rye bread, flatbreads in the freezer.

THE SPICE TIN

Cumin (ground and seed), smoked paprika, ground coriander, turmeric, chilli flakes, cinnamon, dried oregano, za'atar, ras el hanout, garam masala, berbere, Chinese five-spice, a Cajun blend, sumac.

TINS & JARS

Chickpeas, black beans, cannellini, brown and dried split fava beans, chopped tomatoes, full-fat coconut milk, tuna in olive oil, anchovies, olives, capers.

THE FREEZER

Raw king prawns, salmon fillets, peas, edamame. Ginger and garlic blitzed to a paste and frozen in an ice-cube tray is the single best twenty-minute-dinner investment there is.

FINISHERS

Toasted almonds, walnuts, sesame and pumpkin seeds, nori, dates. The handful scattered at the end is what makes a fast dish taste considered.

FIVE RULES FOR A TWENTY-MINUTE DINNER

- 1 Preheat before you chop.** The air fryer or the pan should be properly hot by the time the board is clear. This alone takes three or four minutes off almost every recipe here.
- 2 Cut for the clock.** Nothing cooking in under fifteen minutes should be thicker than your thumb. Small and even beats big and hopeful.
- 3 Season twice.** Once in the pan, once at the table. The second pass is nearly always acid — a squeeze of lemon, a splash of vinegar — and it is what makes fast food taste finished.
- 4 Always add something raw.** Herbs, sliced chilli, spring onion, a spoonful of yoghurt. Fifteen seconds of work, and it is the difference between a meal and a plate of cooked ingredients.
- 5 Wash up while it rests.** Two minutes with the pan still warm, instead of ten with it cold. Every recipe here is built around one pan or one basket for exactly this reason.

Lunch & Dinner

Grouped by how much of your attention they need. The air fryer looks after itself while you set the table; the stove wants five unbroken minutes; the no-cook recipes want nothing but a sharp knife.

AIR FRYER

15 recipes

01	Harissa Chickpea & Cauliflower Crunch	18min
02	Miso-Glazed Salmon with Charred Tenderstem	12min
03	Peri-Peri Chicken Thighs with Blistered Peppers	18min
04	Tandoori Paneer Tikka Skewers	15min
05	Gochujang Tofu with Smashed Sesame Cucumber	18min
06	Za'atar Chicken with Lemon Courgette	18min
07	Chilli-Lime Prawns with Avocado & Coriander	10min
08	Sicilian Sea Bass with Fennel, Olive & Orange	14min
09	Jerk Chicken with Charred Pineapple	18min
10	Shawarma-Spiced Turkey with Sumac Onions	15min
11	Berberes Sweet Potato & Lentil Bowl	20min
12	Cajun Blackened Cod with Charred Corn Salsa	12min
13	Furikake Salmon Rice Bowl	15min
14	Chermoula Prawns with Courgette Ribbons	12min
15	Salt & Pepper Tofu with Pak Choi	18min

WOK

5 recipes

18	Ginger-Garlic Prawn & Broccoli Stir-Fry	10min
19	Sichuan Cumin Beef with Peppers	12min
36	Lomo Saltado	15min
39	Nasi Goreng Cauliflower Rice with Fried Egg	15min
40	Sambal Green Beans with Egg	12min

NO COOK

5 recipes

46	Deconstructed Vietnamese Summer Roll Bowl	15min
47	Fattoush with Crisped Chickpeas	15min
48	Salmon Poke Bowl	12min
49	Prawn Ceviche Tostada Salad	15min
50	Turkish Çoban Salad with Tuna & Sumac	10min

ONE PAN

25 recipes

16	Pad Krapow — Thai Basil Chicken	12min
17	Quick Thai Green Curry Prawns	15min
20	Korean Bulgogi Beef Bowl	15min
21	Vietnamese Lemongrass Chicken Bowl	15min
22	Shogayaki — Japanese Ginger Pork with Cabbage	12min
23	Kerala Coconut Prawn Fry	15min
24	Egg & Spinach Bhurji	10min
25	Fifteen-Minute Chana Masala	15min
26	Turkish Menemen	12min
27	Green Shakshuka	15min
28	Greek Lemon Chicken & Orzo	20min
29	Prawn Saganaki with Feta	15min
30	Broccoli Aglio e Olio with Anchovy	15min
31	Tuscan White Bean, Kale & Lemon Skillet	12min
32	Tuna Puttanesca Beans	12min
33	Gambas al Ajillo with Chickpeas	12min
34	Smoky Paprika Chicken with Piquillo Peppers	18min
35	Chipotle Black Bean & Charred Corn Skillet	15min
37	Moqueca Express — Brazilian Coconut Fish Stew	18min
38	Filipino Adobo Flash Chicken	18min
41	Burmese Golden Turmeric Chicken	15min
42	Ethiopian Gomen with Spiced Eggs	15min
43	Ras el Hanout Turkey with Herbs & Almonds	15min
44	West African Peanut Stew Express	20min
45	Georgian Walnut-Garlic Green Beans with Eggs	15min

Breakfast

Savoury more often than sweet, because savoury is faster and keeps you full until lunch. Six of these are on the table in ten minutes; three of them never see heat.

 AIR FRYER 5 recipes

- 51 Sweet Potato, Egg & Chilli Hash 18min
- 52 Halloumi, Tomato & Za'atar Plate 12min
- 53 Masala Omelette Muffins 15min
- 54 Banana, Oat & Almond Butter Bake 18min
- 55 Crispy Chickpea, Avocado & Lemon Toast 12min

 WOK 2 recipes

- 66 Egg & Tomato Stir-Fry 10min
- 67 Sinangag — Filipino Garlic Rice & Egg 12min

 NO COOK 3 recipes

- 68 Ten-Minute Bircher Muesli 10min
- 69 Danish Rye with Cottage Cheese, Cucumber & Dill 8min
- 70 Orange, Date & Almond Yoghurt Bowl 8min

 ONE PAN 10 recipes

- 56 Tamagoyaki with Rice & Nori 12min
- 57 Gyeran Bap — Korean Egg Rice 10min
- 58 Ten-Minute Ginger Congee 15min
- 59 Rava Uttapam with Coconut Chutney 18min
- 60 Persian Herb & Feta Omelette 15min
- 61 Huevos Rancheros Rápidos 15min
- 62 Pan con Tomate with Soft Eggs 10min
- 63 Ful Medames 12min
- 64 Buckwheat Galette with Egg & Greens 18min
- 65 Khao Tom — Thai Rice Soup with Prawns 15min

TWENTY MINUTES ON SUNDAY Three small jobs that turn nine of these breakfasts into five-minute ones

Cook a large pot of rice

Cold cooked rice is the backbone of five recipes here — the congee, the two fried rices, the egg rice and the rice soup. It keeps three days and fries far better cold than warm.

Toast a tray of nuts and seeds

Almonds, walnuts, pumpkin and sesame seeds, eight minutes in the air fryer at 160°C. Into a jar, and every bowl and salad in the book gets its finish for free.

Blitz ginger and garlic

A whole head of garlic and a thumb of ginger to a paste, frozen in an ice-cube tray. One cube is roughly one recipe, and it removes the only fiddly job most of these have.

 AIR FRYER

Everything goes in one basket. Preheat, load, walk away, come back to something blistered at the edges.

 ONE PAN

A single wide pan on the hob, start to finish. Nothing is browned in batches and set aside.

 WOK

Very high heat and constant movement. Have every ingredient cut and within reach before it goes on.

 NO COOK

No heat at all beyond, occasionally, a kettle. A knife, a board, a bowl.

Every recipe serves four, lists metric quantities first with US cups and ounces alongside, and assumes a cold start. The ring beside each title shows the total time against a twenty-minute dial; the strip at the foot of the page gives approximate nutrition per serving, and the line beneath it tells you exactly what you will be washing.

By Cuisine

Cook your way around the world on a Tuesday. Nothing here has been simplified into blandness — the shortcuts are in the technique and the cut, not in the seasoning.

American

- 51 Sweet Potato, Egg & Chilli Hash

American (Louisiana)

- 12 Cajun Blackened Cod with Charred Corn Salsa

Brazilian

- 37 Moqueca Express — Brazilian Coconut Fish Stew

British

- 54 Banana, Oat & Almond Butter Bake

Burmese

- 41 Burmese Golden Turmeric Chicken

Chinese

- 18 Ginger-Garlic Prawn & Broccoli Stir-Fry
58 Ten-Minute Ginger Congee
66 Egg & Tomato Stir-Fry

Chinese (Cantonese)

- 15 Salt & Pepper Tofu with Pak Choi

Chinese (Sichuan)

- 19 Sichuan Cumin Beef with Peppers

Cypriot

- 52 Halloumi, Tomato & Za'atar Plate

Danish

- 69 Danish Rye with Cottage Cheese, Cucumber & Dill

Egyptian

- 63 Ful Medames

Ethiopian

- 11 Berbere Sweet Potato & Lentil Bowl
42 Ethiopian Gomen with Spiced Eggs

Filipino

- 38 Filipino Adobo Flash Chicken
67 Sinangag — Filipino Garlic Rice & Egg

French (Breton)

- 64 Buckwheat Galette with Egg & Greens

Georgian

- 45 Georgian Walnut-Garlic Green Beans with Eggs

Ghanaian / Senegalese

- 44 West African Peanut Stew Express

Greek

- 28 Greek Lemon Chicken & Orzo
29 Prawn Saganaki with Feta

Hawaiian-Japanese

- 13 Furikake Salmon Rice Bowl
48 Salmon Poke Bowl

Indian

- 04 Tandoori Paneer Tikka Skewers
24 Egg & Spinach Bhurji
25 Fifteen-Minute Chana Masala
53 Masala Omelette Muffins

Indian (South)

- 23 Kerala Coconut Prawn Fry
59 Rava Uttapam with Coconut Chutney

Indonesian

- 39 Nasi Goreng Cauliflower Rice with Fried Egg

Iranian

- 60 Persian Herb & Feta Omelette

Israeli / Levantine

- 27 Green Shakshuka

Italian

- 30 Broccoli Aglio e Olio with Anchovy
32 Tuna Puttanesca Beans

Italian (Sicilian)

- 08 Sicilian Sea Bass with Fennel, Olive & Orange

Italian (Tuscan)

- 31 Tuscan White Bean, Kale & Lemon Skillet

Jamaican

- 09 Jerk Chicken with Charred Pineapple

Japanese

- 02 Miso-Glazed Salmon with Charred Tenderstem
22 Shogayaki — Japanese Ginger Pork with Cabbage
56 Tamagoyaki with Rice & Nori

Korean

- 05 Gochujang Tofu with Smashed Sesame Cucumber
20 Korean Bulgogi Beef Bowl
57 Gyeran Bap — Korean Egg Rice

Lebanese

- 47 Fattoush with Crisped Chickpeas

Levantine

- 06 Za'atar Chicken with Lemon Courgette

Malaysian

- 40 Sambal Green Beans with Egg

Mexican

- 07 Chilli-Lime Prawns with Avocado & Coriander
35 Chipotle Black Bean & Charred Corn Skillet
61 Huevos Rancheros Rápidos

Middle Eastern

- 10 Shawarma-Spiced Turkey with Sumac Onions

Modern Levantine

- 55 Crispy Chickpea, Avocado & Lemon Toast

Moroccan

- 14 Chermoula Prawns with Courgette Ribbons
43 Ras el Hanout Turkey with Herbs & Almonds
70 Orange, Date & Almond Yoghurt Bowl

Peruvian

- 36 Lomo Saltado

Peruvian-Mexican

- 49 Prawn Ceviche Tostada Salad

Portuguese-Mozambican

- 03 Peri-Peri Chicken Thighs with Blistered Peppers

Spanish

- 33 Gambas al Ajillo with Chickpeas
34 Smoky Paprika Chicken with Piquillo Peppers
62 Pan con Tomate with Soft Eggs

Swiss

- 68 Ten-Minute Bircher Muesli

Thai

- 16 Pad Krapow — Thai Basil Chicken
17 Quick Thai Green Curry Prawns
65 Khao Tom — Thai Rice Soup with Prawns

Tunisian / North African

- 01 Harissa Chickpea & Cauliflower Crunch

Turkish

- 26 Turkish Menemen
50 Turkish Çoban Salad with Tuna & Sumac

Vietnamese

- 21 Vietnamese Lemongrass Chicken Bowl
46 Deconstructed Vietnamese Summer Roll Bowl

What to Cook When

Nobody stands in the kitchen at seven o'clock thinking in cuisines. This is the index for the way the question actually arrives.

There is nothing in the house but eggs

24 Egg & Spinach Bhurji **26** Turkish Menemen
27 Green Shakshuka **60** Persian Herb & Feta Omelette
66 Egg & Tomato Stir-Fry

Someone is arriving at eight and it is ten to

02 Miso-Glazed Salmon **07** Chilli-Lime Prawns
18 Ginger-Garlic Prawn Stir-Fry **32** Tuna Puttanesca Beans
62 Pan con Tomate & Soft Eggs

It is cold, and grey, and has been for weeks

25 Chana Masala **37** Moqueca Express
44 West African Peanut Stew **58** Ginger Congee
65 Khao Tom

Payday is Friday and it is Tuesday

24 Egg & Spinach Bhurji **25** Chana Masala
31 Tuscan White Bean & Kale **32** Tuna Puttanesca Beans
63 Ful Medames

You want something green on the plate

05 Gochujang Tofu **27** Green Shakshuka
30 Broccoli Aglio e Olio **42** Ethiopian Gomen
45 Georgian Green Beans

It is Sunday and you have twenty unhurried minutes

49 Prawn Ceviche Tostada **51** Sweet Potato, Egg & Chilli Hash
54 Banana & Oat Bake **59** Rava Uttapam
64 Buckwheat Galette

It is far too hot to turn anything on

46 Vietnamese Summer Roll Bowl **48** Salmon Poke Bowl
49 Prawn Ceviche Tostada **50** Turkish Coban Salad
69 Danish Rye & Cottage Cheese

Someone claims not to like vegetables

16 Pad Krapow **20** Korean Bulgogi Beef Bowl
35 Chipotle Black Bean & Charred Corn Skillet
61 Huevos Rancheros Rápidos **67** Sinangag

You have ten minutes, and that is the whole budget

07 Chilli-Lime Prawns **18** Ginger-Garlic Prawn Stir-Fry
57 Gyeran Bap **62** Pan con Tomate & Soft Eggs
66 Egg & Tomato Stir-Fry

You want it to taste like a holiday

09 Jerk Chicken **16** Pad Krapow **33** Gambas al Ajillo
36 Lomo Saltado **48** Salmon Poke Bowl

You want to feel virtuous without feeling deprived

11 Berbere Sweet Potato **31** Tuscan White Bean & Kale
46 Vietnamese Summer Roll Bowl
47 Fattoush & Crisped Chickpeas **68** Bircher Muesli

You cannot face the washing up at all

02 Miso-Glazed Salmon **12** Cajun Blackened Cod
50 Turkish Coban Salad **69** Danish Rye & Cottage Cheese
70 Orange, Date & Almond Yoghurt

You are cooking to impress someone

08 Sicilian Sea Bass **09** Jerk Chicken **29** Prawn Saganaki
36 Lomo Saltado **48** Salmon Poke Bowl

You need it to keep you full until two o'clock

51 Sweet Potato, Egg & Chilli Hash
53 Masala Omelette Muffins
55 Crispy Chickpea & Avocado Toast **63** Ful Medames
67 Sinangag

You want the whole flat to smell extraordinary

04 Tandoori Paneer Tikka Skewers **09** Jerk Chicken
23 Kerala Coconut Prawn Fry
41 Burmese Golden Turmeric Chicken **59** Rava Uttapam

There is half a cabbage and a lot of optimism

05 Gochujang Tofu **15** Salt & Pepper Tofu with Pak Choi
22 Shogayaki **48** Salmon Poke Bowl **68** Bircher Muesli

Lunch & Dinner

Everything on the table inside twenty minutes from a cold start, across thirty-six kitchens, leaving one pan or one basket behind.

50 RECIPES	36 CUISINES	10 MINUTES, FASTEST	16 UNDER TWELVE MINUTES
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IF YOU ONLY COOK THREE

16

Pad Krapow — Thai Basil Chicken

Twelve minutes, one wok, and the dish that converts people to cooking fast.

01

Harissa Chickpea & Cauliflower Crunch

The whole dinner in one basket, and a sauce you stir in a mug while it cooks.

29

Prawn Saganaki with Feta

Prawns, tomatoes and feta in a pan, on the table before anyone has finished a drink.

HARISSA CHICKPEA & CAULIFLOWER CRUNCH · MISO-GLAZED SALMON WITH CHARRED TENDERSTEM · PERI-PERI CHICKEN THIGHS WITH BLISTERED PEPPERS · TANDOORI PANEER TIKKA SKEWERS · GOCHUJANG TOFU WITH SMASHED SESAME CUCUMBER · ZA'ATAR CHICKEN WITH LEMON COURGETTE · CHILLI-LIME PRAWNS WITH AVOCADO & CORIANDER · SICILIAN SEA BASS WITH FENNEL, OLIVE & ORANGE · JERK CHICKEN WITH CHARRED PINEAPPLE · SHAWARMA-SPICED TURKEY WITH SUMAC ONIONS · BERBERE SWEET POTATO & LENTIL BOWL · CAJUN BLACKENED COD WITH CHARRED CORN SALSA · FURIKAKE SALMON RICE BOWL · CHERMOULA PRAWNS WITH COURGETTE RIBBONS · SALT & PEPPER TOFU WITH PAK CHOI · PAD KRAPOW — THAI BASIL CHICKEN · QUICK THAI GREEN CURRY PRAWNS · GINGER-GARLIC PRAWN & BROCCOLI STIR-FRY · SICHUAN CUMIN BEEF WITH PEPPERS · KOREAN BULGOGI BEEF BOWL · VIETNAMESE LEMONGRASS CHICKEN BOWL · SHOGAYAKI — JAPANESE GINGER PORK WITH CABBAGE · KERALA COCONUT PRAWN FRY · EGG & SPINACH BHURJI · FIFTEEN-MINUTE CHANA MASALA · TURKISH MENEMEN · GREEN SHAKSHUKA · GREEK LEMON CHICKEN & ORZO · PRAWN SAGANAKI WITH FETA · BROCCOLI AGLIO E OLIO WITH ANCHOVY · TUSCAN WHITE BEAN, KALE & LEMON SKILLET · TUNA PUTTANESCA BEANS · GAMBAS AL AJILLO WITH CHICKPEAS · SMOKY PAPRIKA CHICKEN WITH PIQUILLO PEPPERS · CHIPOTLE BLACK BEAN & CHARRED CORN SKILLET · LOMO SALTADO · MOQUECA EXPRESS — BRAZILIAN COCONUT FISH STEW · FILIPINO ADOBO FLASH CHICKEN · NASI GORENG CAULIFLOWER RICE WITH FRIED EGG · SAMBAL GREEN BEANS WITH EGG · BURMESE GOLDEN TURMERIC CHICKEN · ETHIOPIAN GOMEN WITH SPICED EGGS · RAS EL HANOUT TURKEY WITH HERBS & ALMONDS · WEST AFRICAN PEANUT STEW EXPRESS · GEORGIAN WALNUT-GARLIC GREEN BEANS WITH EGGS · DECONSTRUCTED VIETNAMESE SUMMER ROLL BOWL · FATTOUSH WITH CRISPED CHICKPEAS · SALMON POKE BOWL · PRAWN CEVICHE TOSTADA SALAD · TURKISH ÇOBAN SALAD WITH TUNA & SUMAC

 15 AIR FRYER

 25 ONE PAN

 5 WOK

 5 NO COOK

01 Harissa Chickpea & Cauliflower Crunch



AIR FRYER

TUNISIAN / NORTH AFRICAN — 5 PREP / 13 COOK — SERVES 4

18
MIN

Everything goes in one basket, comes out blistered and craggy, and gets cooled down by a lemony yoghurt you stir in a mug.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 2 × 400 g (14 oz) tins chickpeas, drained and patted dry
- 1 medium cauliflower (~700 g / 1½ lb), broken into small florets
- 2 tbsp rose harissa paste
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) olive oil
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- ½ tsp fine sea salt

TO FINISH

- 200 g (¾ cup) thick Greek yoghurt
- 1 lemon — zest and juice of half, rest cut into wedges
- 1 small garlic clove, grated
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley or mint, roughly torn
- 30 g (¼ cup) toasted almonds or pumpkin seeds

WHY IT WORKS

Draining chickpeas well and tossing them straight with harissa means the paste dries onto the skins and turns into a crust rather than a sauce. Cauliflower cut small enough cooks in the same window, so one basket does the whole dinner.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F).
- 2 Tip the dry chickpeas and cauliflower straight into the basket. Add the harissa, oil, cumin and salt and toss with your hands until everything is streaked red.
- 3 Air fry for 13 minutes, shaking the basket hard at 7 minutes. It is ready when the cauliflower edges are charred and the chickpeas rattle.
- 4 While it cooks, stir the yoghurt, garlic, lemon zest and juice together in a mug or small bowl with a pinch of salt.
- 5 Pile the basket contents onto plates, spoon over the yoghurt, scatter with herbs and nuts, and serve with lemon wedges.

SWAP

Broccoli, romanesco or thick carrot batons all work on the same timer. Butter beans instead of chickpeas give you a creamier, less crunchy version.

BULK IT OUT

Serve over warm couscous (covered in boiling water for 5 minutes while the basket runs) or with flatbread.

MAKE IT FASTER

Buy pre-cut cauliflower florets and you are down to 3 minutes of prep.

LEFTOVERS

Keeps 3 days chilled. Eat cold in a salad rather than reheating — it loses its crunch.

395 kcal
CALORIES

19 g
PROTEIN

38 g
CARBS

18 g
FAT

13 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one mug, one chopping board.

02 Miso-Glazed Salmon with Charred Tenderstem

12
MIN



AIR FRYER

JAPANESE — 3 PREP / 9 COOK — SERVES 4

Three-ingredient glaze, one basket, nine minutes. The most reliable weeknight fish there is.

INGREDIENTS

- 4 salmon fillets (~150 g / 5 oz each), skin on
- 300 g (10 oz) tenderstem broccoli or long-stem broccolini
- 2 tbsp white miso paste
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) mirin (or 2 tsp honey + 1 tsp water)
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) rice vinegar
- 2 tsp toasted sesame oil
- 1 tsp finely grated fresh ginger
- 1 tbsp sesame seeds
- 2 spring onions, finely sliced

WHY IT WORKS

Miso is already fermented and salty, so it seasons and browns at the same time — no marinating window needed. The broccoli goes in underneath the fillets and catches the glaze as it drips.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Stir the miso, mirin, vinegar and ginger together in a small bowl.
- 2 Toss the broccoli with the sesame oil and lay it flat in the basket. Sit the salmon fillets on top, skin down, and brush the tops thickly with the miso glaze.
- 3 Air fry for 9 minutes. The glaze should be dark and bubbling at the edges and the salmon should flake when pressed at its thickest point.
- 4 Lift onto plates, scatter with sesame seeds and spring onion, and spoon any glaze from the basket over the broccoli.

SWAP

Cod, sea bass or thick-cut trout all work — drop to 7 minutes for thinner white fish. Firm tofu slabs need 12 minutes.

BULK IT OUT

A pouch of microwave brown rice or a handful of soba noodles cooked in 4 minutes.

MAKE IT FASTER

Double the glaze and keep it in a jar; it lives happily in the fridge for a month.

LEFTOVERS

Excellent cold, flaked into a rice bowl with cucumber.

405 kcal
CALORIES

36 g
PROTEIN

9 g
CARBS

24 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one small bowl, one pastry brush.

03 Peri-Peri Chicken Thighs with Blistered Peppers

18
MIN

 AIR FRYER

PORTUGUESE-MOZAMBICAN — 5 PREP / 13 COOK — SERVES 4

A peri-peri rub built from two chillies and a lemon, blistering onto chicken while the peppers soften in the drippings underneath.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 800 g (1¾ lb) boneless, skinless chicken thighs
- 3 romano peppers (~450 g / 1 lb), deseeded and cut into thick strips
- 1 red onion, cut into eight wedges

FOR THE PERI-PERI RUB

- 2 red bird's eye chillies, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, grated
- 2 tsp smoked paprika
- 1 tsp dried oregano
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) red wine vinegar
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) olive oil
- Zest and juice of 1 lemon
- 1 tsp fine sea salt

TO FINISH

- 15 g (½ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, chopped
- 1 lemon, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Boneless thighs opened out flat cook through in thirteen minutes and stay juicy where breast would tighten and dry. The vinegar and lemon keep the rub loose enough to coat every surface, so it browns into a lacquer rather than pooling in the drawer.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Open the thighs out on the board and press the thick lobes flat so each is an even 2 cm (¾ in).
- 2 Stir the chilli, garlic, paprika, oregano, vinegar, oil, lemon zest and juice and salt in a bowl. Add the chicken and turn it until every piece is streaked red.
- 3 Spread the peppers and onion across the basket, lay the chicken on top in a single layer and scrape the last of the rub over.
- 4 Air fry for 13 minutes, turning the chicken once at 8 minutes. It is ready when the edges have caught dark and the juices run clear at the thickest point — 74°C (165°F) on a probe.
- 5 Let it settle for the minute it takes to find plates, then serve with the peppers, the pan juices, parsley and lemon wedges.

SWAP

Drumsticks work on the same rub but need 20 minutes. Halloumi or thick portobello slices take 10.

BULK IT OUT

Warm flatbreads in the hot empty basket for 60 seconds, or serve over rice.

MAKE IT FASTER

Double the rub and keep half in a jar; it holds two weeks chilled and cuts prep to two minutes.

LEFTOVERS

Shred the cold chicken through the peppers with more lemon. Keeps 3 days chilled.

440 kcal
CALORIES

37 g
PROTEIN

10 g
CARBS

27 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one mixing bowl, one chopping board.

04 Tandoori Paneer Tikka Skewers

15
MIN



AIR FRYER

INDIAN — 7 PREP / 8 COOK — SERVES 4

Paneer takes on its yoghurt marinade in the time it takes to cut the peppers, then chars at the corners in eight minutes.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE SKEWERS

- 450 g (1 lb) paneer, cut into 3 cm (1¼ in) cubes
- 1 red and 1 green pepper, cut into 3 cm squares
- 1 red onion, quartered and separated into petals
- 150 g (½ cup) thick Greek yoghurt
- 3 garlic cloves, grated
- 1 tbsp finely grated fresh ginger
- 2 tsp garam masala
- 2 tsp ground cumin
- 1 tsp Kashmiri chilli powder (or ½ tsp cayenne plus ½ tsp paprika)
- ½ tsp ground turmeric
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) groundnut oil
- 1 tsp fine sea salt

TO FINISH

- 15 g (⅓ cup, packed) coriander, torn
- 1 lemon, cut into wedges
- 8 short metal skewers

WHY IT WORKS

Thick yoghurt clings to paneer rather than sliding off, and the milk solids in that coating brown hard under the fan — that is where the tandoor char comes from without a tandoor. Paneer is acid-set, so it never melts: the cubes hold their edges while the surface blackens.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Whisk the yoghurt, garlic, ginger, garam masala, cumin, chilli, turmeric, oil and salt in a bowl until it is the colour of terracotta.
- 2 Add the paneer, peppers and onion. Fold gently so the cubes keep their corners, then thread onto the skewers, alternating cheese and vegetable.
- 3 Lay the skewers in the basket in one layer, a finger's gap between them, and spoon over any marinade left in the bowl.
- 4 Air fry for 8 minutes, turning them at 5 minutes. They are ready when the yoghurt coating has dried to a crust and there are proper black blisters on the pepper skins.
- 5 Scatter with coriander and squeeze over lemon while the skewers still steam.

SWAP

Extra-firm tofu takes the same marinade and the same 8 minutes. Chicken thigh cut to 3 cm needs 12.

BULK IT OUT

Warm chapatis, or a bowl of basmati with cucumber and more yoghurt.

MAKE IT FASTER

Skip the skewers and air fry everything loose in the basket, shaking once — it is the same dish, two minutes quicker.

LEFTOVERS

Pull the cold pieces off the skewers into a wrap. Keeps 2 days chilled.

385 kcal
CALORIES

22 g
PROTEIN

11 g
CARBS

27 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one mixing bowl, one chopping board, eight skewers.

05 Gochujang Tofu with Smashed Sesame Cucumber

18
MIN



AIR FRYER

KOREAN — 6 PREP / 12 COOK — SERVES 4

Tofu goes in plain, comes out with a chewy skin, and meets a sticky gochujang glaze and a cold, garlicky cucumber bruised with the flat of a knife.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) extra-firm tofu, patted dry and cut into 3 cm (1¼ in) cubes
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) toasted sesame oil

FOR THE GLAZE

- 2 tbsp gochujang
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) soy sauce
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) rice vinegar
- 1 tbsp honey
- 2 garlic cloves, grated

FOR THE CUCUMBER

- 2 cucumbers (~600 g / 1 lb 5 oz)
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) rice vinegar
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) toasted sesame oil
- 1 garlic clove, grated
- 1 tbsp sesame seeds
- 2 spring onions, finely sliced

WHY IT WORKS

Tofu is glazed after cooking, not before: the sugar in gochujang scorches long before the cubes crisp, so the fryer dries them first and the sauce goes on at the end. Smashing the cucumber rather than slicing it tears the flesh into rough facets that hold dressing, and the salt pulls out water so nothing dilutes it.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Toss the tofu with the sesame oil and spread it in a single layer in the basket. Air fry for 12 minutes, shaking at 6.
- 2 Lay the cucumbers on the board, press hard with the flat of a knife until they split, then chop into rough 3 cm chunks. Toss with the salt in a bowl.
- 3 Stir the gochujang, soy, vinegar, honey and garlic together in a mug.
- 4 Tip the cucumber's salty water away and dress it with the vinegar, sesame oil, garlic, sesame seeds and spring onion.
- 5 The tofu is done when the cubes sound hollow against the basket and the corners are deep gold. Tip them into the glaze and toss until every face is red and sticky. Serve the cucumber alongside, cold against hot.

SWAP

Tempeh takes 10 minutes; chicken thigh cubes take 14 and want the same glaze.

BULK IT OUT

Short-grain rice, or cold soba noodles tossed with the cucumber dressing.

MAKE IT FASTER

Glaze in the basket itself once cooking is done — one less thing to wash.

LEFTOVERS

The tofu softens overnight but reheats crisp in 4 minutes. Keeps 3 days chilled.

350 kcal
CALORIES

23 g
PROTEIN

15 g
CARBS

21 g
FAT

4 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one bowl, one mug, one chopping board.

06 Za'atar Chicken with Lemon Courgette

18
MIN



AIR FRYER

LEVANTINE — 5 PREP / 13 COOK — SERVES 4

Za'atar toasts on the surface of the chicken while courgettes underneath collapse into something halfway between roasted and braised.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 4 chicken breasts (~200 g / 7 oz each), butterflied and opened flat
- 3 courgettes (~600 g / 1 lb 5 oz), cut into 2 cm (¾ in) half-moons
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) olive oil
- 3 tbsp za'atar
- 3 garlic cloves, grated
- Zest of 1 lemon, plus the juice of half
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper

TO FINISH

- 100 g (⅓ cup) thick Greek yoghurt
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, roughly chopped
- 1 lemon, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Za'atar is mostly sesame and dried thyme, and both scorch quickly, so the blend goes on under a film of olive oil that slows the heat and lets it toast rather than burn. Butterflying the breasts to an even thickness gets them cooked in thirteen minutes, exactly as long as thick courgette half-moons need to give up their water and brown.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Run a knife horizontally through each breast and open it like a book so it lies at an even 2 cm.
- 2 In a bowl, mix the oil, za'atar, garlic, lemon zest and juice, salt and pepper into a loose paste. Toss the courgettes through half of it and spread them across the basket.
- 3 Rub the rest over the chicken, both sides, and lay the pieces on top of the courgettes without overlapping.
- 4 Air fry for 13 minutes. The chicken is done when it springs back under a finger and shows no pink at the thickest part — 74°C (165°F) on a probe. The courgette edges should be brown and shrunken.
- 5 Slice the chicken thickly across the grain, pile it onto the courgettes and finish with yoghurt, parsley and a squeeze of lemon.

SWAP

Thighs need 15 minutes; thick aubergine slices stand in for courgette on the same timer.

BULK IT OUT

Couscous steeped in boiling water for 5 minutes while the basket runs, or warm pitta.

MAKE IT FASTER

Ask for the breasts butterflied at the counter and you are down to 3 minutes of prep.

LEFTOVERS

Cold, chopped, with the courgettes and yoghurt as a lunchbox salad. Keeps 3 days chilled.

375 kcal
CALORIES

47 g
PROTEIN

9 g
CARBS

16 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one mixing bowl, one chopping board.

07 Chilli-Lime Prawns with Avocado & Coriander

10
MIN

 AIR FRYER

MEXICAN — 4 PREP / 6 COOK — SERVES 4

Six minutes from cold prawns to hot, smoky, lime-sharp ones, tipped over avocado that has been mashed roughly on the board.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) raw king prawns, peeled and deveined, patted dry
- 1½ tbsp (22 ml) olive oil
- 2 tsp smoked paprika
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 1 tsp dried chilli flakes, or 1 red chilli finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, grated
- ½ tsp fine sea salt

TO FINISH

- 2 large ripe avocados
- Juice of 2 limes, plus 1 more cut into wedges
- ½ small red onion, very finely sliced
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) coriander, leaves and stalks, chopped

WHY IT WORKS

Prawns cook by residual heat as much as anything, so they go in dry and come out at the moment they curl into a loose C — a tight O means they have gone one minute too far. The lime juice is added off the heat: in the basket it would boil away, but poured over hot prawns it lifts steam and carries the chilli with it.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Toss the dry prawns in a bowl with the oil, paprika, cumin, chilli, garlic and salt until they are evenly rust-coloured.
- 2 Spread them in a single layer in the basket — crowding them steams them grey rather than roasting them.
- 3 Air fry for 6 minutes, shaking once at 4 minutes. They are ready the moment they turn opaque pink and curl into a loose C shape.
- 4 While they cook, halve and stone the avocados, scoop the flesh onto the board and crush it roughly with a fork, leaving lumps. Spread across a platter or four plates and season.
- 5 Tip the prawns and everything clinging to the basket over the avocado, squeeze the lime juice on while they still hiss, then scatter with red onion and coriander. Serve with lime wedges.

SWAP

Scallops need 5 minutes, firm white fish chunks 7. Frozen prawns work if defrosted and properly dried.

BULK IT OUT

Warm corn tortillas, or black beans heated through with a little of their own liquid.

MAKE IT FASTER

Mix the spices with the oil in the bowl the night before and the prawns need 30 seconds of tossing.

LEFTOVERS

Eat within a day, cold, in a tortilla — reheating turns prawns rubbery.

345 kcal
CALORIES

31 g
PROTEIN

6 g
CARBS

21 g
FAT

8 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one mixing bowl, one chopping board.

08 Sicilian Sea Bass with Fennel, Olive & Orange

14
MIN

 AIR FRYER

ITALIAN (SICILIAN) — 4 PREP / 10 COOK — SERVES 4

Fennel gets a four-minute head start, then the fish goes on top and the whole thing finishes together under a slick of orange and olive.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 2 fennel bulbs (~500 g / 1 lb 2 oz), trimmed and sliced 5 mm thick
- 4 sea bass fillets (~130 g / 4½ oz each), skin on
- 100 g (¾ cup) green olives, squashed and stoned
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) olive oil
- 2 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 1 tsp dried oregano
- ½ tsp dried chilli flakes
- Zest and juice of 1 orange
- ½ tsp fine sea salt

TO FINISH

- 15 g (⅓ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, chopped
- Any reserved fennel fronds

WHY IT WORKS

Fennel sliced thin enough to be translucent will soften in the same window as a fish fillet, but it still needs a head start to lose its raw crunch — four minutes alone does it. Sitting the bass skin-up on the fennel means the fillets steam gently from below while the skin dries and crisps above.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 190°C (375°F). Toss the fennel in the basket with 2 tbsp of the oil, the garlic, oregano, chilli, half the orange zest and the salt. Air fry for 4 minutes.
- 2 Meanwhile, pat the bass dry — skin will not crisp through moisture — and rub it with the remaining oil and a pinch of salt.
- 3 Shake the fennel, scatter over the olives, then lay the fillets on top, skin up, without overlapping.
- 4 Air fry for 6 minutes more. The fish is done when the flesh turns from glassy to white and the thickest part flakes cleanly under a fork; the skin should be tight and blistered.
- 5 Squeeze the orange juice over the fennel, not the skin, and finish with the rest of the zest, parsley and fronds.

SWAP

Bream, red mullet or thin cod fillets all take the same 6 minutes. Capers instead of olives, a tablespoon, rinsed.

BULK IT OUT

Boiled new potatoes crushed into the fennel juices, or bread for mopping.

MAKE IT FASTER

Slice the fennel on the coarse side of a box grater or a mandoline in under a minute.

LEFTOVERS

The fennel and olives are better the next day, cold, as a salad. Eat the fish the same evening.

300 kcal
CALORIES

26 g
PROTEIN

9 g
CARBS

17 g
FAT

5 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one chopping board.

09 Jerk Chicken with Charred Pineapple

18
MIN



AIR FRYER

JAMAICAN — 6 PREP / 12 COOK — SERVES 4

A jerk rub stirred in a bowl rather than blitzed in a blender, with pineapple going dark and jammy in the gaps between the thighs.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE RUB

- 2 tsp ground allspice
- 1 tsp dried thyme, or 1 tbsp fresh leaves
- ½ tsp ground cinnamon
- ¼ tsp freshly grated nutmeg
- 1 scotch bonnet, deseeded and very finely chopped
- 4 spring onions, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, grated
- 1 tbsp finely grated fresh ginger
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) soy sauce
- 1 tbsp honey
- Juice of 1 lime
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) olive oil
- ¾ tsp fine sea salt

FOR THE BASKET

- 800 g (1¾ lb) boneless, skinless chicken thighs
- ½ pineapple (~400 g / 14 oz prepared), cut into 2 cm (¾ in) wedges

TO FINISH

- 15 g (½ cup, packed) coriander
- 1 lime, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Allspice, thyme and scotch bonnet are the backbone of jerk, and a rub built on grated aromatics gets there without a blender to wash. Pineapple has enough sugar to caramelize in twelve minutes and enough acid to season the chicken as its juices run into the drawer.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Stir every rub ingredient together in a bowl into a thick, dark, spoonable paste.
- 2 Open the thighs out flat on the board so they are an even thickness, add them to the bowl and work the rub in by hand. Wash your hands afterwards; the scotch bonnet lingers.
- 3 Lay the chicken in the basket in one layer and tuck the pineapple into the gaps.
- 4 Air fry for 12 minutes, turning chicken and pineapple at 7 minutes. The chicken is ready when the rub has dried to a near-black crust and the juices run clear — 74°C (165°F) on a probe. The pineapple should be blistered and slumping.
- 5 Serve straight from the basket, coriander torn over, lime to squeeze.

SWAP

Half a habanero or a hot red chilli if scotch bonnet is hard to find. Mango chars the same way.

BULK IT OUT

Rice and peas, or flatbreads warmed in the empty basket.

MAKE IT FASTER

The rub keeps a week in a jar — make it ahead and this is a 14-minute dinner.

LEFTOVERS

Chop the cold chicken and pineapple together into a slaw. Keeps 3 days chilled.

475 kcal
CALORIES

38 g
PROTEIN

18 g
CARBS

27 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one mixing bowl, one chopping board.

10 Shawarma-Spiced Turkey with Sumac Onions

15
MIN



AIR FRYER

MIDDLE EASTERN — 5 PREP / 10 COOK — SERVES 4

Turkey cut into thin strips crisps at the edges under a shawarma spicing, served with red onions gone soft and pink in nothing but sumac and lemon.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 700 g (1½ lb) turkey breast steaks, cut into 1 cm (½ in) strips
- 2½ tbsp (38 ml) olive oil
- 2 tsp ground cumin
- 2 tsp ground coriander
- 1½ tsp sweet paprika
- ½ tsp ground cinnamon
- ½ tsp ground turmeric
- 3 garlic cloves, grated
- Juice of ½ lemon
- 1 tsp fine sea salt

FOR THE SUMAC ONIONS

- 2 red onions, halved and sliced as thinly as you can
- 2 tsp sumac
- Juice of ½ lemon
- ¼ tsp fine sea salt
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, chopped

TO FINISH

- 200 g (¾ cup) thick Greek yoghurt
- 1 lemon, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Cutting turkey breast into 1 cm strips triples the surface area, so the spices toast and the edges frizzle in ten minutes — the char a vertical spit gives, without the spit. Salting the onions with sumac and lemon while the basket runs draws out their bite, so they arrive sharp rather than raw and harsh.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Toss the turkey strips in a bowl with the oil, all the spices, garlic, lemon juice and salt until evenly ochre.
- 2 Scatter the strips loosely across the basket in a rough single layer — a heap will steam and stay pale.
- 3 Air fry for 10 minutes, shaking hard at 5 minutes to separate any strips that have knitted together.
- 4 Meanwhile, put the onions on the board, sprinkle with sumac and salt, squeeze over the lemon and scrunch until they slacken and turn magenta. Fold through the parsley.
- 5 The turkey is done when the thinnest strips are browned and the thickest opaque all through. Pile onto plates with the onions, spoon over yoghurt and add lemon wedges.

SWAP

Chicken thigh strips take 12 minutes; sliced halloumi or cauliflower steaks take 12 as well.

BULK IT OUT

Flatbreads, or bulgur soaked in boiling water for 10 minutes while the basket runs.

MAKE IT FASTER

Buy turkey mini fillets and slice them lengthways — two cuts each and the prep is done.

LEFTOVERS

Excellent cold in a wrap with the onions. Keeps 3 days chilled.

390 kcal
CALORIES

47 g
PROTEIN

11 g
CARBS

17 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one mixing bowl, one chopping board.

11 Berbere Sweet Potato & Lentil Bowl

20
MIN



AIR FRYER

ETHIOPIAN — 5 PREP / 15 COOK — SERVES 4

Sweet potato gets a head start in the basket, then drained lentils drop in late to crisp against the hot metal.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 800 g (1¾ lb) sweet potatoes, scrubbed and cut into 2 cm (¾ in) cubes
- 2 × 400 g (14 oz) tins green or brown lentils, drained and patted dry
- 1½ tbsp berbere spice blend
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) olive oil
- 1 tsp fine sea salt
- 4 garlic cloves, thinly sliced

TO FINISH

- 200 g (¾ cup) thick Greek yoghurt
- 1 lemon — half juiced, half cut into wedges
- 200 g (7 oz) cherry tomatoes, halved
- 1 small red onion, very thinly sliced
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) coriander, roughly chopped

WHY IT WORKS

Berbere is chilli-led but built on fenugreek and warm spices, which need fat and direct heat rather than a long simmer — in a hot oiled basket the blend blooms in minutes. Cutting the sweet potato to 2 cm brings it inside a fifteen-minute window, and holding the lentils back until the last five means they toast rather than collapse.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Toss the sweet potato in the basket with 2 tbsp of the oil, 1 tbsp berbere and the salt until every cube is rust-coloured.
- 2 Air fry for 10 minutes, shaking hard at 5 minutes.
- 3 Add the dry lentils, garlic and remaining oil and berbere. Shake and air fry 5 minutes more, until a cube of sweet potato gives with no resistance and the lentils look dry and toasted rather than glossy.
- 4 Meanwhile stir the yoghurt with the lemon juice and a pinch of salt, and toss the tomatoes and onion together on your board.
- 5 Spoon the basket into four bowls, add the tomatoes and onion, spoon over the yoghurt and scatter with coriander. Serve with lemon wedges.

SWAP

Butternut squash or thick carrot batons run on the same timer. Chickpeas in place of lentils give a firmer, nuttier bite.

BULK IT OUT

Warm flatbread for scooping, or a pouch of brown rice stirred through the bowl.

MAKE IT FASTER

Cut the sweet potato to 1.5 cm and the basket time drops to 11 minutes total.

LEFTOVERS

Keeps 3 days chilled and is better cold than reheated — dress with more lemon and eat as a salad.

450 kcal
CALORIES

18 g
PROTEIN

62 g
CARBS

14 g
FAT

14 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one small bowl, one chopping board.

12 Cajun Blackened Cod with Charred Corn Salsa

12
MIN

 AIR FRYER

AMERICAN (LOUISIANA) — 4 PREP / 8 COOK — SERVES 4

Cod under a thick coat of smoked paprika and cayenne, sweetcorn charring underneath, and a salsa stirred together in the residual heat.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 4 thick cod loin fillets (~150 g / 5 oz each), patted very dry
- 300 g (2 cups) sweetcorn kernels, from 3 cobs or frozen and thawed
- 2 tsp smoked paprika
- 1 tsp dried oregano
- 1 tsp dried thyme
- 1 tsp garlic granules
- ½ tsp cayenne pepper
- ½ tsp coarsely ground black pepper
- ¾ tsp fine sea salt
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) olive oil

FOR THE SALSA

- 1 small red onion, finely diced
- 1 red chilli, finely chopped
- 2 limes — 1 juiced, 1 cut into wedges
- 1 ripe avocado, diced
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) coriander, chopped

WHY IT WORKS

Blackening is a dry rub meeting dry fish at high heat, so patting the fillets is the whole trick — surface water makes the spices steam into a paste instead of scorching into a crust. The corn sits on the basket floor, taking the most direct heat and blistering in exactly the eight minutes the cod needs.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Mix the paprika, oregano, thyme, garlic granules, cayenne, black pepper and salt on your board.
- 2 Rub the cod with 1 tbsp of the oil, then press the spice mix onto every surface until the fillets look genuinely dark, not dusted.
- 3 Toss the corn with the remaining oil and spread it flat in the basket. Sit the cod on top and air fry 8 minutes, until the rub is near-black at the edges and the fish parts into thick opaque petals under a fork.
- 4 Tip the hot corn into a bowl and stir through the onion, chilli, lime juice, avocado and coriander — the heat takes the raw edge off the onion.
- 5 Plate the cod, pile the salsa alongside and add lime wedges.

SWAP

Haddock, pollock or salmon take the same rub. Chicken thigh fillets need 14 minutes.

BULK IT OUT

Warm corn tortillas, or rice put on as the basket goes in.

MAKE IT FASTER

Mix a jar of the rub in advance; it keeps six months and is just as good on prawns.

LEFTOVERS

Flake the cold fish through the remaining salsa with more lime for a next-day lunch.

335 kcal
CALORIES

34 g
PROTEIN

22 g
CARBS

12 g
FAT

5 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one mixing bowl, one chopping board.

13 Furikake Salmon Rice Bowl



AIR FRYER

HAWAIIAN-JAPANESE — 5 PREP / 10 COOK — SERVES 4

15
MIN

Salmon lacquered with soy and honey, flaked hot over warm rice, then buried under toasted sesame and torn nori.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 4 salmon fillets (~150 g / 5 oz each), skin on
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) soy sauce
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) honey
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) rice vinegar
- 2 tsp finely grated fresh ginger
- 1 tsp toasted sesame oil

FOR THE BOWLS

- 600 g (about 4 cups) cooked short-grain rice, warm
- 2 tbsp toasted white and black sesame seeds
- 2 sheets nori, torn into small pieces
- ½ tsp flaky sea salt
- 1 cucumber, halved and sliced on the diagonal
- 1 ripe avocado, sliced
- 3 spring onions, finely sliced

WHY IT WORKS

Honey and soy brown far faster together than either does alone, so ten minutes in a hot basket builds a sticky glaze without drying the fillet past medium. Flaking the fish while it is hot lets the glaze run down into the rice instead of sitting on top.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Stir the soy, honey, vinegar, ginger and sesame oil together in a small bowl.
- 2 Sit the salmon skin-down in the basket and brush thickly with half the glaze. Air fry for 10 minutes, brushing on the rest at 6 minutes. It is done when the surface is dark and tacky and the thickest part flakes under light pressure; a little translucence at the centre is what you want.
- 3 Meanwhile, mix the sesame seeds, torn nori and flaky salt on your board. This is your furikake.
- 4 Divide the warm rice between four bowls. Flake the salmon off its skin over the top in large pieces, and spoon any glaze left in the basket over each.
- 5 Add the cucumber and avocado, then scatter generously with the furikake and spring onions.

SWAP

Trout or thick mackerel fillets both take the glaze well; mackerel needs only 7 minutes.

BULK IT OUT

Add shelled edamame or quick-pickled radish, thinly sliced and left in rice vinegar while the salmon cooks.

MAKE IT FASTER

Cook a double batch of rice at the weekend — this bowl is built around rice you already have.

LEFTOVERS

Keep salmon and rice separate and eat cold next day; reheating the rice under flaked fish makes it gluey.

510 kcal
CALORIES

34 g
PROTEIN

48 g
CARBS

20 g
FAT

4 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one small bowl, one pastry brush, one chopping board.

14 Chermoula Prawns with Courgette Ribbons

12
MIN

 AIR FRYER

MOROCCAN — 7 PREP / 5 COOK — SERVES 4

A green, garlicky chermoula does double duty here — half coats the prawns for the basket, half dresses raw courgette ribbons that never see a pan.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE CHERMOULA

- 30 g (¾ cup, packed) coriander, leaves and fine stalks
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley
- 4 garlic cloves
- 1½ tsp ground cumin
- 1 tsp sweet paprika
- ¼ tsp chilli flakes
- 1 lemon — zest and juice
- 5 tbsp (75 ml) olive oil
- ¾ tsp fine sea salt

FOR THE REST

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) raw king prawns, peeled and deveined, patted dry
- 3 medium courgettes (~600 g / 1 lb 5 oz)
- 30 g (¼ cup) toasted flaked almonds
- 1 lemon, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Chermoula is a raw herb sauce, so the cumin and paprika only bloom once they hit hot oil on the prawns — which is why no marinating window is needed. Prawns need five minutes at most, and courgettes peeled into ribbons are thin enough to soften in the dressing's acid while the basket runs.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Chop the herbs, garlic and spices together on your board until fine, then scrape into a bowl with the lemon zest and juice, oil and salt.
- 2 Toss the prawns with half the chermoula directly in the basket, spreading them into a single layer.
- 3 Run a peeler down the courgettes into long ribbons, stopping at the seedy core. Toss with the remaining chermoula and a pinch of salt and leave to slacken while the prawns cook.
- 4 Air fry the prawns for 5 minutes, shaking at 3. They are ready the moment they curl into loose C-shapes and turn opaque — a tight O means a minute too far.
- 5 Pile the ribbons onto plates, spoon the prawns and their basket juices over, scatter with almonds and serve with lemon wedges.

SWAP

Chermoula suits any firm white fish; cod chunks need 8 minutes. Halved chestnut mushrooms make a good meat-free version at 10 minutes.

BULK IT OUT

Couscous covered in boiling water and left for 5 minutes, or warm flatbread.

MAKE IT FASTER

Blitz the chermoula in a mini processor and prep drops to 4 minutes.

LEFTOVERS

Best eaten straight away — reheated prawns toughen. Chermoula alone keeps a week under a film of oil.

290 kcal
CALORIES

28 g
PROTEIN

8 g
CARBS

16 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one bowl, one chopping board, one peeler.

15 Salt & Pepper Tofu with Pak Choi

 AIR FRYER

CHINESE (CANTONESE) — 6 PREP / 12 COOK — SERVES 4

18
MIN

Cornflour-dusted tofu goes craggy in the basket, pak choi joins late, and the garlic and chilli go in at the very end so they toast rather than scorch.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 2 × 400 g (14 oz) blocks extra-firm tofu, pressed briefly and cut into 3 cm (1¼ in) cubes
- 3 tbsp cornflour (cornstarch)
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) groundnut or vegetable oil
- 300 g (10 oz) pak choi, halved lengthways
- 5 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 2 red chillies, sliced
- 4 spring onions, cut into 3 cm lengths

FOR THE SALT AND PEPPER MIX

- 1 tsp Sichuan peppercorns, toasted and crushed
- 1 tsp black peppercorns, crushed
- ½ tsp ground white pepper
- 1 tsp flaky sea salt
- ½ tsp caster sugar

WHY IT WORKS

A thin coat of cornflour pulls surface moisture off the tofu and sets into a shell, giving the shattery edges a deep-fryer would — without the litre of oil. The aromatics go in for the last two minutes only, because sliced garlic and chilli turn bitter long before tofu is ready.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Roll the tofu in the cornflour on your board until evenly dusty, then tip into the basket and toss with 2 tbsp of the oil.
- 2 Air fry 8 minutes, shaking firmly at 4. The cubes should sound light and rattle against the basket.
- 3 Meanwhile, crush the peppercorns and mix with the white pepper, salt and sugar.
- 4 Toss the pak choi with the remaining oil, add to the basket and air fry 2 minutes. Add the garlic, chilli and spring onions and air fry 2 minutes more — the tofu deep gold, the pak choi stems still squeaky at the base.
- 5 Tip everything into a warm bowl, scatter the salt and pepper mix over while hot and toss once so it clings. Serve immediately.

SWAP

King oyster mushrooms in thick coins take the same treatment and timings. Prawns need only 5 minutes.

BULK IT OUT

Steamed jasmine rice, or plain noodles tossed with the seasoned oil from the basket.

MAKE IT FASTER

Skip the pressing — extra-firm tofu blotted hard with a tea towel is dry enough.

LEFTOVERS

The coating softens overnight. Bring it back with 4 minutes at 200°C rather than a microwave.

340 kcal
CALORIES

22 g
PROTEIN

20 g
CARBS

19 g
FAT

5 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one serving bowl, one chopping board.

16 Pad Krapow — Thai Basil Chicken

🍳 ONE PAN

THAI — 5 PREP / 7 COOK — SERVES 4

12
MIN

Chicken chopped by hand rather than minced, hit hard with garlic and bird's eye chilli, finished with two handfuls of basil off the heat.

INGREDIENTS

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) boneless chicken thighs, skin removed
- 6 garlic cloves
- 3–4 bird's eye chillies, more if you like heat
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) groundnut or vegetable oil
- 1½ tbsp (22 ml) fish sauce
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) light soy sauce
- 2 tsp dark soy sauce
- 2 tsp palm sugar or soft brown sugar
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) water
- 1 small onion, sliced
- 100 g (3½ oz) green beans, cut into 2 cm lengths
- 40 g (2 cups, loosely packed) holy basil or Thai basil leaves

WHY IT WORKS

Chopping thigh meat by knife leaves ragged pieces that brown in patches and stay juicy, where mince packs together and steams. The basil goes in off the heat — holy basil loses its peppery, clove-like edge within about thirty seconds of direct cooking.

METHOD

- 1 Chop the chicken into rough 1 cm pieces — coarse and uneven is right. Flatten the garlic and chillies with the side of the knife and chop to a rough paste.
- 2 Stir the fish sauce, both soys, sugar and water in a small bowl.
- 3 Get a large frying pan very hot, add the oil, then the garlic and chilli. Stir 15 seconds, until it smells sharp and the garlic is just turning pale gold.
- 4 Add the chicken and spread it out. Leave 90 seconds without stirring to take colour, then stir-fry 3 minutes until no pink remains.
- 5 Add the onion, beans and sauce. Cook hard for 2 minutes, until the liquid reduces to a glossy coating and the beans are still bright.
- 6 Off the heat, throw in the basil and stir just until it wilts. Serve straight away over rice.

SWAP

Pork shoulder, turkey thigh or crumbled firm tofu all work. Swap the dark soy for 1 tbsp oyster sauce for a rounder version.

BULK IT OUT

Jasmine rice and a fried egg with lacy edges, cooked in the same pan after.

MAKE IT FASTER

Chop the garlic and chilli paste in bulk and freeze in teaspoon blobs.

LEFTOVERS

Keeps 3 days and reheats well, though the basil fades — add fresh leaves at the table.

365 kcal
CALORIES

38 g
PROTEIN

12 g
CARBS

18 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one small bowl, one chopping board.

17 Quick Thai Green Curry Prawns



ONE PAN

THAI

5 PREP / 10 COOK

SERVES 4

15
MIN

The paste fries in the thick cream from the top of the tin until the oil splits out green — the difference between a proper curry and hot coconut soup.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 × 400 ml (14 fl oz) tin full-fat coconut milk, unshaken
- 3 tbsp Thai green curry paste
- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) raw king prawns, peeled and deveined
- 150 g (5 oz) green beans, halved
- 1 courgette, in thick half-moons
- 100 g (3½ oz) sugar snap peas
- 1½ tbsp (22 ml) fish sauce
- 2 tsp palm sugar or soft brown sugar
- 3 makrut lime leaves, torn (optional)
- 1 lime, half juiced, half in wedges
- 20 g (1 cup, loosely packed) Thai basil leaves
- 1 red chilli, sliced

WHY IT WORKS

Cracking the coconut cream and frying the paste in it toasts the lemongrass and galangal, giving depth you would otherwise only get from long simmering. Prawns go in for the final three minutes so they poach gently rather than tighten in a boiling pan.

METHOD

- 1 Open the tin without shaking and spoon the thick cream from the top into a cold, wide pan. Set the thin milk beneath aside.
- 2 Cook the cream over medium-high heat 2–3 minutes, stirring, until it thickens, sputters and green-tinged oil separates at the edges. Add the paste and fry 90 seconds, pressing it into the oil, until it smells fragrant and darkens.
- 3 Pour in the reserved milk with the fish sauce, sugar and lime leaves and bring to a gentle simmer.
- 4 Add the beans and courgette and simmer 4 minutes, then the sugar snaps and prawns for a final 3. The prawns are done as soon as they turn opaque and curl loosely; the beans should still snap.
- 5 Off the heat, stir in the lime juice and most of the basil, then taste and adjust with more fish sauce or lime. Scatter with chilli and the rest of the basil.

SWAP

Chicken thigh strips need 8 minutes in the sauce; firm tofu and aubergine need 10.

BULK IT OUT

Jasmine rice, or rice noodles soaked while the curry simmers.

MAKE IT FASTER

Frozen raw prawns go straight in — add them a minute earlier.

LEFTOVERS

Keeps 2 days. Reheat gently to steaming only, or the prawns turn rubbery.

400 kcal
CALORIES

28 g
PROTEIN

14 g
CARBS

26 g
FAT

4 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One wide pan, one chopping board, one small jug.

18 Ginger-Garlic Prawn & Broccoli Stir-Fry



WOK

CHINESE — 5 PREP / 5 COOK — SERVES 4

10
MIN

A splash of water and a lid turn the wok into a steamer, so the broccoli is done before the prawns go in.

INGREDIENTS

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) raw king prawns, peeled and patted dry
- 400 g (14 oz) broccoli, in small florets, stem peeled and sliced
- 30 g (1 oz) ginger, finely julienned
- 5 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) groundnut or vegetable oil
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) water, plus 60 ml (¼ cup) for steaming
- 2½ tbsp (37 ml) light soy sauce
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) Shaoxing wine or dry sherry
- 2 tsp rice vinegar
- 2 tsp honey
- 2 tsp cornflour (cornstarch)
- 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
- ½ tsp chilli flakes
- 3 spring onions, in 3 cm lengths

WHY IT WORKS

Stir-frying alone scorches broccoli before the stems soften, so a covered steam does the interior and open heat does the browning. Mixing the cornflour into the sauce in advance means it thickens in seconds — long enough to glaze, too quick to overcook the prawns.

METHOD

- 1 Stir the soy, Shaoxing wine, vinegar, honey, cornflour, sesame oil, chilli flakes and 3 tbsp water in a small bowl until smooth.
- 2 Heat the wok until a drop of water skitters and vanishes. Add 1 tbsp oil, then the broccoli, and toss 1 minute for colour.
- 3 Pour in the 60 ml water, cover and steam 90 seconds. Lift the lid — the water should be gone, the florets bright green with give in the stem. Tip onto a plate.
- 4 Back on high heat with the remaining oil. Add the ginger and garlic, stir 20 seconds, then the prawns in one layer. Leave 45 seconds, then toss 1 minute until opaque and just curling.
- 5 Return the broccoli, stir the sauce and pour it in. Toss 30–45 seconds until glossy and clinging. Add the spring onions, toss once and serve.

SWAP

Sliced chicken breast needs 3 minutes instead of 2. Tenderstem or green beans swap straight in; mangetout skips the steam.

BULK IT OUT

Rice, or 300 g cooked egg noodles added with the sauce to take on the glaze.

MAKE IT FASTER

Buy the broccoli ready-cut and this is a five-minute dinner.

LEFTOVERS

Keeps 2 days. Eat cold or reheat fast in the wok; a microwave overcooks the prawns.

290 kcal
CALORIES

30 g
PROTEIN

13 g
CARBS

13 g
FAT

4 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One wok and lid, one small bowl, one chopping board, one plate.

19 Sichuan Cumin Beef with Peppers



WOK

CHINESE (SICHUAN) — 7 PREP / 5 COOK — SERVES 4

Toasted cumin, numbing peppercorn, and beef that hits the wok in one layer and leaves it four minutes later.

INGREDIENTS

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) beef rump or sirloin, sliced 3 mm thin across the grain
- 1 tbsp cornflour
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) light soy sauce
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) Shaoxing wine or dry sherry
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) groundnut or rapeseed oil
- 2 red peppers, cut into 2 cm squares
- 1 tbsp cumin seeds
- 1–2 tsp dried chilli flakes
- 1 tsp Sichuan peppercorns, crushed
- 4 garlic cloves, sliced
- 20 g (¾ in) fresh ginger, matchsticked
- 4 spring onions, cut into 3 cm lengths
- 15 g (½ cup, packed) coriander, chopped

WHY IT WORKS

Sliced thin across the grain and tossed with cornflour, the beef takes a coat that seizes on hot metal, so it browns instead of stewing. The whole spices go in after the peppers, where twenty seconds in hot oil wakes the cumin without scorching it.

METHOD

- 1 Toss the beef with the cornflour, 1 tbsp of the soy and the Shaoxing in a bowl. Cut everything else before you light the hob.
- 2 Heat the wok until a bead of water skitters and vanishes. Add 1 tbsp oil, then half the beef in one layer. Leave it 45 seconds, until the underside is deeply browned, toss 30 seconds, and tip onto a plate. Repeat.
- 3 Add the remaining oil and the peppers. Stir-fry 90 seconds, to blistered black patches and flesh that is still squeaky.
- 4 Push the peppers up the side. Drop the cumin, chilli flakes and Sichuan pepper into the oil at the base for 20 seconds, until fragrant, then the garlic and ginger for 20 more.
- 5 Return the beef and its juices with the last of the soy. Toss 30 seconds, until the wok is dry and glossy rather than wet. Off the heat, fold through the spring onions and coriander.

SWAP

Lamb leg steak is the original Xinjiang version and behaves identically. Torn king oyster mushrooms need 3 minutes.

BULK IT OUT

Steamed rice, or flatbreads warmed in the dry wok before you start.

MAKE IT FASTER

Freeze the beef for 15 minutes before slicing; it cuts thin in half the time.

LEFTOVERS

Keeps 2 days chilled. Reheat in the wok for 60 seconds, or eat it cold.

385 kcal
CALORIES

38 g
PROTEIN

12 g
CARBS

20 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One wok, one bowl, one board, one plate.

20 Korean Bulgogi Beef Bowl

🍳 ONE PAN

KOREAN — 8 PREP / 7 COOK — SERVES 4

15
MIN

Grated pear does in ten minutes what an overnight marinade does, and the beef caramelises in the liquid it came in.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BEEF

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) beef sirloin or rump, sliced as thinly as you can
- ½ ripe pear, coarsely grated
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) light soy sauce
- 1 tbsp honey
- 1 tbsp toasted sesame oil
- 4 garlic cloves, crushed
- 15 g (½ in) fresh ginger, grated
- ½ tsp coarse black pepper
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) rapeseed oil

FOR THE BOWLS

- 600 g (about 3 cups) hot cooked short-grain rice
- 1 cucumber, halved, seeds scraped, sliced into half-moons
- 1 tsp rice vinegar and a pinch of salt
- 4 spring onions, finely sliced
- 2 tsp toasted sesame seeds
- 1 tsp gochugaru

WHY IT WORKS

Pear carries enzymes that start softening muscle fibre on contact, so thin sirloin turns tender in the time it takes to shred a cucumber. Cook it in two batches over high heat and the sugars catch rather than boiling into a grey pool.

METHOD

- 1 Stir the pear, soy, honey, sesame oil, garlic, ginger and pepper together in a bowl. Add the beef, work it through with your fingers and leave it while you do everything else.
- 2 Toss the cucumber with the vinegar and salt straight in the serving bowls.
- 3 Heat the rapeseed oil in a large frying pan over a high heat. Lift half the beef out, letting the marinade drain back, and spread it in one layer. Leave it a minute, until the edges are lacquered dark, then toss a minute more. Move to a plate and repeat.
- 4 Pour the leftover marinade into the hot pan and bubble it 45 seconds, until syrupy. Return the beef and toss to coat.
- 5 Pile the rice into the bowls, add the beef and its sauce, and finish with spring onion, sesame and gochugaru.

SWAP

Thin-sliced pork shoulder makes dwaeji bulgogi — add 1 tbsp gochujang to the marinade. Thick portobello slices take 4 minutes.

BULK IT OUT

A fried egg per bowl, or bean sprouts wilted in the pan heat.

MAKE IT FASTER

Ask the butcher to slice the sirloin, or use frozen shabu-shabu beef straight from the packet.

LEFTOVERS

3 days chilled; better cold in a lettuce wrap than reheated.

470 kcal
CALORIES

36 g
PROTEIN

42 g
CARBS

17 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one mixing bowl, one board, one plate.

21 Vietnamese Lemongrass Chicken Bowl



🍲 ONE PAN

VIETNAMESE — 8 PREP / 7 COOK — SERVES 4

Chicken thighs cooked hard in lemongrass and fish sauce, tipped over cold noodles, cucumber and a heap of soft herbs.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE CHICKEN

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) boneless chicken thighs, cut into 3 cm pieces
- 2 lemongrass stalks, outer layers stripped, cores very finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, crushed
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) fish sauce
- 1 tbsp honey
- ½ tsp coarse black pepper
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) rapeseed oil

FOR THE BOWLS

- 200 g (7 oz) dried rice vermicelli
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) lime juice
- 1 tbsp fish sauce
- 1 tbsp honey
- 1 red chilli, finely sliced
- 2 carrots, coarsely grated
- 1 cucumber, cut into batons
- 30 g (1 cup, packed) mint and coriander leaves
- 40 g (¼ cup) roasted peanuts, crushed

WHY IT WORKS

Fish sauce and honey reduce in the pan to a lacquer on the meat, so the bowl needs nothing beyond a sharp lime dressing. Thighs carry enough fat to take a fierce heat for seven minutes without drying, which is what gives you the dark caught edges.

METHOD

- 1 Boil the kettle. Toss the chicken with the lemongrass, garlic, fish sauce, honey and pepper in a bowl.
- 2 Put the vermicelli in a large heatproof bowl, cover with boiling water and leave 4 minutes, until pliable with a little bite. Drain, rinse cold and leave in the colander.
- 3 Heat the oil in a large frying pan over medium-high. Spread the chicken out and leave it 3 minutes without stirring, until the undersides are dark. Turn and cook 4 minutes more, until firm and the juices run clear.
- 4 Whisk the lime juice, fish sauce, honey, chilli and 3 tbsp water in the emptied noodle bowl.
- 5 Divide the noodles between bowls with the carrot, cucumber and herbs. Add the chicken, spoon over the dressing and scatter with peanuts.

SWAP

Pork shoulder steaks, sliced thin, cook in the same time. Firm tofu needs 6 minutes in a drier pan.

BULK IT OUT

Double the noodles, or add shredded little gem and raw beansprouts.

MAKE IT FASTER

Blitz the lemongrass, garlic and chilli together while the kettle boils.

LEFTOVERS

Keep the dressing separate and it holds 2 days. Good cold, straight from the fridge.

470 kcal
CALORIES

34 g
PROTEIN

52 g
CARBS

13 g
FAT

4 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one large bowl, a colander and a board.

22 Shogayaki — Japanese Ginger Pork with Cabbage



🍳 ONE PAN

JAPANESE — 5 PREP / 7 COOK — SERVES 4

Thin pork, a serious amount of grated ginger, and a cold mound of shredded cabbage to cut through it.

INGREDIENTS

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) pork loin steaks, sliced 5 mm thin
- 30 g (2 tbsp) fresh ginger, finely grated, juice and all
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) soy sauce
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) mirin
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) sake or dry sherry
- 1 tsp honey
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) rapeseed oil
- ¼ small white cabbage (about 300 g / 10 oz), shredded as finely as you can
- 1 tsp rice vinegar
- 2 spring onions, sliced
- 1 lemon, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Ginger juice does the tenderising, so the pork needs no marinating window — it goes into the pan dry and meets the sauce only at the end. Pouring the sauce into a hot, already browned pan lets it reduce to a glaze in a minute instead of steaming the meat pale.

METHOD

- 1 Stir the ginger, soy, mirin, sake and honey together in a small bowl.
- 2 Shred the cabbage and pile it onto four plates. Sprinkle with the vinegar and a pinch of salt.
- 3 Heat the oil in a large frying pan over a high heat. Lay in half the pork in one layer and cook 60–90 seconds a side, until the edges are browned and no pink remains. Move to a plate and repeat.
- 4 Return all the pork to the pan, pour in the sauce and let it bubble hard for a minute, turning the slices, until it thickens enough to cling.
- 5 Slide the pork and its sauce onto the cabbage. Scatter with spring onion and serve with lemon wedges.

SWAP

Chicken thigh, opened out flat, takes 3 minutes a side. Thick aubergine slices work with an extra spoon of oil.

BULK IT OUT

A bowl of rice each, and miso soup made while the pan heats.

MAKE IT FASTER

Buy pork ready-sliced for shabu-shabu; it cooks in 40 seconds a side.

LEFTOVERS

2 days chilled. Chop and fold through rice with an egg for a fast fried rice.

335 kcal
CALORIES

35 g
PROTEIN

11 g
CARBS

16 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one small bowl, one board.

23 Kerala Coconut Prawn Fry

15
MIN



ONE PAN

INDIAN (SOUTH) — 7 PREP / 8 COOK — SERVES 4

Mustard seeds popping in coconut oil, curry leaves crackling, prawns in and out of the pan in three minutes.

INGREDIENTS

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) raw king prawns, peeled and patted dry
- ½ tsp ground turmeric
- 1 tsp Kashmiri chilli powder
- 1 tsp coarsely cracked black pepper
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) coconut oil
- 1 tsp black mustard seeds
- 20 fresh curry leaves
- 4 shallots, finely sliced
- 4 garlic cloves, finely chopped
- 20 g (¾ in) fresh ginger, finely chopped
- 2 green chillies, split lengthways
- 60 g (¾ cup) fresh or frozen grated coconut
- 1 lime, halved
- 15 g (½ cup, packed) coriander, chopped

WHY IT WORKS

Prawns need barely three minutes, so the masala is built first and they go in last, onto a base that is already sweet and softened. The grated coconut goes in after that, where residual heat toasts it just enough to cling to the prawns.

METHOD

- 1 Toss the prawns with the turmeric, chilli powder, pepper and salt in a bowl.
- 2 Heat the coconut oil in a wide frying pan over a medium-high heat. Add the mustard seeds and wait for them to pop, about 30 seconds, then the curry leaves — they will spit and crackle.
- 3 Add the shallots and cook 4 minutes, stirring, until soft and edged with brown. Add the garlic, ginger and chillies and stir 1 minute, until the raw smell goes.
- 4 Turn the heat high and spread the prawns out in one layer. Leave them 90 seconds, then toss and cook 60–90 seconds more, until they curl into loose C shapes and are opaque right through. A tight O means they have gone too far.
- 5 Scatter in the coconut and toss a minute, until it smells toasted and clings. Off the heat, squeeze over the lime and stir through the coriander.

SWAP

Firm white fish in 3 cm chunks needs 4 minutes and gentler turning. Squid rings take 90 seconds flat.

BULK IT OUT

Rice, or 200 g spinach wilted into the pan just before the prawns go in.

MAKE IT FASTER

Frozen raw prawns thaw in 5 minutes in cold water while you slice the shallots.

LEFTOVERS

2 days chilled. Warm gently — a hard reheat turns prawns rubbery.

315 kcal
CALORIES

30 g
PROTEIN

9 g
CARBS

18 g
FAT

4 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one bowl, one board.

24 Egg & Spinach Bhurji



🍳 ONE PAN

INDIAN — 3 PREP / 7 COOK — SERVES 4

Indian scrambled eggs with tomato, green chilli and a whole bag of spinach folded in at the last second.

INGREDIENTS

- 10 large eggs
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- 2 tbsp (30 g) ghee or butter
- 1 tsp cumin seeds
- 1 red onion, finely chopped
- 2 green chillies, finely chopped
- 15 g (½ in) fresh ginger, grated
- 2 ripe tomatoes, chopped
- ½ tsp ground turmeric
- 1 tsp garam masala
- 200 g (7 oz) spinach, roughly chopped
- 20 g (¾ cup, packed) coriander, chopped
- 1 lime, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Cooking the onion and tomato hard until the fat separates and pools at the edges builds the base in four minutes, long before the eggs arrive. Take the pan off the heat while the curds still look glossy and slightly loose — they carry on setting on their own.

METHOD

- 1 Beat the eggs with the salt in a jug and set them beside the hob.
- 2 Melt the ghee in a large frying pan over a medium-high heat. Add the cumin seeds, let them sizzle 20 seconds, then add the onion, chillies and ginger. Cook 2 minutes, until the onion is translucent and just catching.
- 3 Add the tomatoes, turmeric and garam masala. Cook 2 minutes, mashing with the spoon, until the tomatoes collapse and the ghee separates out at the edges.
- 4 Pile in the spinach and stir a minute, until it has wilted and the pan looks dry again — wet spinach makes watery eggs.
- 5 Turn the heat low, pour in the eggs and stir slowly, scraping the base every few seconds. After 2 minutes you will have soft, glossy curds. Off the heat, fold through the coriander and serve with lime.

SWAP

Kale needs 3 minutes rather than 1. Crumbled paneer in place of two of the eggs makes it firmer.

BULK IT OUT

Warm chapatis, or spoon it over toast with a little more lime.

MAKE IT FASTER

Chop the onion, chilli and ginger together in one go on the board, and grate the tomatoes instead of chopping.

LEFTOVERS

2 days chilled. Best cold in a wrap; reheating tightens the eggs.

275 kcal
CALORIES

20 g
PROTEIN

8 g
CARBS

18 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one jug, one board.

25 Fifteen-Minute Chana Masala



ONE PAN

INDIAN

5 PREP / 10 COOK

SERVES 4

Two tins of chickpeas and ten minutes at a proper heat, for a sauce that tastes cooked rather than merely warmed.

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp (30 ml) rapeseed oil or ghee
- 1 tsp cumin seeds
- 1 large onion, finely chopped
- 4 garlic cloves, crushed
- 20 g (¾ in) fresh ginger, grated
- 1 green chilli, finely chopped
- 2 tsp ground coriander
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- ½ tsp ground turmeric
- ½ tsp Kashmiri chilli powder
- 400 g (14 oz) tin chopped tomatoes
- 2 × 400 g (14 oz) tins chickpeas, drained
- 1 tsp garam masala
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- 1 lemon, halved
- 20 g (¾ cup, packed) coriander, chopped

WHY IT WORKS

Frying the ground spices in hot oil for thirty seconds before the tomatoes arrive dissolves them into the fat, which is what separates a cooked-tasting curry from a dusty one. Crushing a quarter of the chickpeas against the side of the pan releases their starch and thickens the sauce without any simmering time.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the oil in a deep frying pan over a high heat. Add the cumin seeds, wait 20 seconds until they darken and smell nutty, then add the onion. Cook 3 minutes, stirring often, until browning at the edges.
- 2 Add the garlic, ginger and chilli for 1 minute, then the ground coriander, cumin, turmeric and chilli powder. Fry 30 seconds — no longer, or they will catch.
- 3 Tip in the tomatoes and cook 3 minutes over a high heat, stirring, until the sauce darkens and thickens enough to leave a trail behind the spoon.
- 4 Add the chickpeas, 150 ml (⅔ cup) water and the salt. Simmer 3 minutes, crushing about a quarter of the chickpeas against the pan side as you stir, until the sauce coats rather than pools.
- 5 Off the heat, stir in the garam masala and a good squeeze of lemon. Taste for salt and sharpness, then scatter with coriander.

SWAP

Black-eyed beans or butter beans work the same way; butter beans crush more readily and thicken faster.

BULK IT OUT

A handful of spinach at step 4, with rice or chapatis alongside.

MAKE IT FASTER

Grate the onion instead of chopping and it softens in half the time.

LEFTOVERS

Better on day two. Keeps 4 days chilled and freezes for 3 months.

355 kcal
CALORIES

15 g
PROTEIN

45 g
CARBS

13 g
FAT

13 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One deep frying pan, one sieve, one board.

26 Turkish Menemen



ONE PAN

TURKISH — 4 PREP / 8 COOK — SERVES 4

12
MIN

Soft green peppers cooked down in olive oil with grated tomato, then eggs stirred through until barely set.

INGREDIENTS

- 4 tbsp (60 ml) olive oil
- 3 long green peppers (or 2 green bell peppers), deseeded and sliced
- 6 ripe tomatoes, coarsely grated and skins discarded (or a 400 g / 14 oz tin of chopped tomatoes)
- 1 tsp pul biber (Aleppo pepper), plus more to finish
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- 8 large eggs
- 20 g (¾ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, chopped
- crusty bread, to serve

WHY IT WORKS

The peppers go in first and get four full minutes alone in the oil, which is what turns them sweet instead of sharp and green. The eggs are broken in with a fork and moved slowly, so they set in soft ribbons through the sauce rather than scrambling into dry lumps.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the olive oil in a wide frying pan over a medium heat. Add the peppers and cook 4 minutes, stirring now and then, until they are limp and blistered at the edges.
- 2 Add the tomatoes, pul biber and salt. Turn the heat up and cook 3 minutes, until the liquid has gone and the oil comes back to the surface in shiny pools.
- 3 Crack the eggs straight into the pan. Break the yolks with a fork and stir once or twice, leaving the whites streaky rather than beaten in.
- 4 Turn the heat low and move the eggs slowly with the fork for 90 seconds, pulling from the outside in. Stop while they still look glossy and a little underdone — the hot pan finishes them.
- 5 Scatter with parsley and more pul biber, and take the pan straight to the table with the bread.

SWAP

Crumbled white cheese stirred in at step 3, or a spoon of thick yoghurt on the side.

BULK IT OUT

More eggs; the pan takes ten. A second pepper stretches it further.

MAKE IT FASTER

Grate whole tomatoes on the coarse side of a box grater — it skips peeling and the chopping board both.

LEFTOVERS

Eat it now. Menemen neither keeps nor reheats well.

290 kcal
CALORIES

16 g
PROTEIN

10 g
CARBS

21 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one grater, one board.

27 Green Shakshuka

15
MIN

🍳 ONE PAN

ISRAELI / LEVANTINE — 5 PREP / 10 COOK — SERVES 4

Eggs poached into a pan of collapsed greens, garlic and green chilli, feta melting into the hollows.

INGREDIENTS

- 3 tbsp (45 ml) olive oil
- 1 leek, halved lengthways and finely sliced
- 4 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 2 green chillies, sliced (deseed for less heat)
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 1 tsp ground coriander
- 1 courgette, coarsely grated
- 400 g (14 oz) spinach or chard leaves, roughly chopped
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) coriander, stalks and leaves separated
- 8 eggs
- 150 g (5 oz) feta, crumbled
- 1 lemon, half juiced and half in wedges
- Salt and black pepper

WHY IT WORKS

Spinach and chard carry enough water to steam themselves down in two minutes, giving you a wet, seasoned bed for the eggs without adding liquid you would then boil off. Pressing the wells down to the metal sets each white against the hot base while the yolk stays loose above it.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the oil in a 28 cm (11 in) frying pan over medium-high. Add the leek and a pinch of salt and cook 2 minutes, until it slumps and turns bright green.
- 2 Add the garlic, chilli, cumin, ground coriander and chopped coriander stalks. Stir 1 minute, until the spices smell toasted.
- 3 Add the courgette and the greens in two handfuls, turning with tongs. Cook 2 minutes, until everything has collapsed and no water pools when you push the greens aside. Stir in the lemon juice and season.
- 4 Make eight wells with the back of a spoon, pressing down to the pan base. Crack an egg into each and scatter the feta into the gaps.
- 5 Cover with a lid or baking tray, drop the heat to low and cook 4–5 minutes, until the whites are opaque right up to the yolk but the yolks still shiver when you nudge the pan. Finish with pepper, coriander leaves and lemon wedges.

SWAP

Kale needs 2 extra minutes before the eggs go in. Ricotta salata stands in for feta.

BULK IT OUT

Warm flatbread in the dry pan before you start, or serve over crushed butter beans.

MAKE IT FASTER

Bagged washed spinach and no courgette takes prep down to 3 minutes.

LEFTOVERS

Eggs do not reheat well. Make the greens base ahead — 3 days chilled, 2 minutes to reheat.

380 kcal
CALORIES

22 g
PROTEIN

12 g
CARBS

27 g
FAT

5 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one box grater, one chopping board.

28 Greek Lemon Chicken & Orzo

20
MIN

🍲 ONE PAN

GREEK — 5 PREP / 15 COOK — SERVES 4

The orzo cooks in the pan with the chicken, drinking up the browned bits and the stock, and comes out creamy without a drop of cream.

INGREDIENTS

- 3 tbsp (45 ml) olive oil
- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) boneless, skinless chicken thighs, cut into 2 cm strips
- 6 spring onions, sliced (or 1 onion, finely chopped)
- 4 garlic cloves, crushed
- 2 tsp dried oregano
- 300 g (1½ cups) orzo
- 750 ml (3 cups) good chicken stock, hot
- 2 lemons — zest of both, juice of one, the rest in wedges
- 150 g (5 oz) spinach
- 100 g (3½ oz) feta, crumbled
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) dill, chopped
- Salt and black pepper

WHY IT WORKS

Orzo cooks through in nine minutes in a shallow layer of stock, and the starch it sheds thickens that stock into a sauce — the risotto trick without the stirring. Searing the chicken first leaves a brown film on the pan base that the stock lifts into every grain.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the oil in a wide, deep sauté pan over high heat. Season the chicken and lay it in one layer. Sear 4 minutes without moving it, until the undersides are properly browned — it will not be cooked through yet.
- 2 Add the spring onions, garlic and oregano and stir 1 minute, until fragrant.
- 3 Tip in the orzo and stir 30 seconds to coat every grain in oil. Pour in the hot stock, bring to a boil and scrape the pan base clean with a wooden spoon.
- 4 Simmer briskly 9 minutes, stirring every minute and reaching into the corners so nothing catches. It is done when the orzo is tender with a slight bite at the centre and the liquid holds a line behind the spoon.
- 5 Off the heat, fold through the lemon zest and juice, then the spinach — it wilts in the residual heat in under a minute. Scatter with feta and dill, add pepper and serve with lemon wedges.

SWAP

Prawns instead of chicken — stir them in for the orzo's last 3 minutes.

BULK IT OUT

A drained tin of butter beans at step 4, plus 100 ml more stock.

MAKE IT FASTER

Boil the stock in the kettle while you cut the chicken.

LEFTOVERS

Keeps 2 days chilled. Reheat with a splash of water — orzo drinks as it sits.

610 kcal
CALORIES

40 g
PROTEIN

57 g
CARBS

24 g
FAT

4 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One deep sauté pan, one chopping board.

29 Prawn Saganaki with Feta

15
MIN

🍳 ONE PAN

GREEK — 5 PREP / 10 COOK — SERVES 4

Prawns cooked straight into a sharp tomato sauce, with chunks of feta dropped on at the end so they soften rather than melt away.

INGREDIENTS

- 3 tbsp (45 ml) olive oil
- 4 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 1 tsp dried oregano
- ½ tsp chilli flakes
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) ouzo or dry white wine (optional)
- 1 × 400 g (14 oz) tin chopped tomatoes
- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) raw king prawns, peeled
- 200 g (7 oz) feta, in rough 2 cm chunks
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, chopped
- 1 lemon, in wedges
- Salt and black pepper

WHY IT WORKS

Prawns give off water as they cook, so the sauce has to be reduced properly before they go in — otherwise it thins out and slides off. Adding the feta off the heat and covering the pan warms it through while it still holds its shape and its salt.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the oil in a large frying pan over medium. Add the garlic, oregano and chilli and cook 1 minute, until the garlic is pale gold. Take it no further than that or it turns bitter.
- 2 Pour in the ouzo and let it bubble for 30 seconds, then add the tomatoes and a good pinch of salt. Simmer hard for 5 minutes, until the sauce holds a clear channel when you drag a spoon across the pan base.
- 3 Stir the prawns in, pushing them under the sauce. Cook 2–3 minutes, turning once, until they are pink and curled into a loose C. A tight O means they have gone too far.
- 4 Take the pan off the heat, scatter the feta over the top and cover for 1 minute so it warms and slumps at the edges.
- 5 Finish with parsley, black pepper and lemon wedges, and serve from the pan with bread for the sauce.

SWAP

Mussels or clams instead of prawns — cover and steam 4 minutes, discarding any that stay shut.

BULK IT OUT

Stir a drained tin of butter beans into the sauce before the prawns go in.

MAKE IT FASTER

Buy prawns already peeled and you lose 4 minutes of prep.

LEFTOVERS

Keeps 2 days chilled. Reheat gently and briefly, or the prawns turn rubbery.

355 kcal
CALORIES

34 g
PROTEIN

6 g
CARBS

21 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one chopping board.

30 Broccoli Aglio e Olio with Anchovy

15
MIN

ONE PAN

ITALIAN — 5 PREP / 10 COOK — SERVES 4

Broccoli steamed and then browned in the same pan, dressed in anchovy-melted garlic oil and covered in toasted sourdough crumbs.

INGREDIENTS

- 2 heads broccoli (~800 g / 1¾ lb), stalks peeled and sliced, tops in small florets
- 75 ml (5 tbsp) olive oil
- 60 g (2 oz) stale sourdough, torn into rough crumbs
- 30 g (¼ cup) almonds, roughly chopped
- 8 anchovy fillets in olive oil, drained
- 6 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- ¾ tsp chilli flakes
- 1 lemon — zest and juice
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, chopped
- Salt and black pepper

WHY IT WORKS

Anchovies dissolve completely in warm oil, leaving savoury depth and no fishiness — they season the dish the way salt does, only rounder. Steaming the broccoli in a splash of water and then letting the pan run dry means it cooks through and browns in one place, without a colander.

METHOD

- 1 Heat 2 tbsp of the oil in a large frying pan over medium. Add the crumbs and almonds and toast 2 minutes, stirring, until sandy gold and crisp. Tip into a small bowl.
- 2 Return the pan to low-medium heat with the remaining oil, the anchovies, garlic and chilli. Cook 2 minutes, mashing the anchovies against the base until they disappear into the oil and the garlic is pale straw.
- 3 Add the broccoli, 100 ml (scant ½ cup) water and a pinch of salt. Cover and cook 4 minutes over high heat, until a knife tip slides into the stalks with slight resistance.
- 4 Uncover and keep the heat high for 2 minutes, pressing the florets against the pan base. It is ready when the water has gone, the pan is glossy rather than wet, and the cut faces have caught brown.
- 5 Off the heat, add the lemon zest and juice, parsley and plenty of pepper. Scatter the crumbs over just before serving so they stay crisp.

SWAP

Cauliflower or romanesco on the same timings. Capers instead of anchovies for a meat-free version.

BULK IT OUT

Toss through cooked spaghetti with a splash of its water, or serve on white beans.

MAKE IT FASTER

Skip the crumbs and use toasted almonds alone — that is 3 minutes saved.

LEFTOVERS

Good cold the next day. Keep the crumbs separate or they go soft.

310 kcal
CALORIES

12 g
PROTEIN

16 g
CARBS

21 g
FAT

7 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one small bowl, one chopping board.

31 Tuscan White Bean, Kale & Lemon Skillet

🍲 ONE PAN

ITALIAN (TUSCAN) — 4 PREP / 8 COOK — SERVES 4

12
MIN

Cannellini beans crushed into their own broth with rosemary, garlic and cavolo nero, sharpened hard with lemon at the end.

INGREDIENTS

- 4 tbsp (60 ml) olive oil, plus more to finish
- 4 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 1 tbsp rosemary leaves, finely chopped
- ½ tsp chilli flakes
- 4 anchovy fillets in olive oil (optional)
- 200 g (7 oz) cavolo nero or kale, stalks stripped, leaves shredded
- 2 × 400 g (14 oz) tins cannellini beans, drained
- 150 ml (⅔ cup) good chicken or vegetable stock
- 1 lemon — zest and juice
- 40 g (1½ oz) Parmesan or pecorino, finely grated
- Salt and black pepper

WHY IT WORKS

Crushing a quarter of the beans against the side of the pan releases their starch, which turns a thin stock into something that coats — no cream, no flour, no extra pan. Adding the lemon off the heat keeps its edge bright, where simmering would flatten it into something dull.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the oil in a large frying pan over medium. Add the garlic, rosemary, chilli and anchovies if using. Cook 2 minutes, pressing the anchovies until they dissolve. The garlic should be pale gold, never brown.
- 2 Add the kale and a pinch of salt and toss 2 minutes, until the leaves darken to deep green and slump into the oil.
- 3 Tip in the beans and stock. Simmer 3 minutes, crushing about a quarter of the beans against the side of the pan with a wooden spoon, until the liquid thickens and clings to the leaves rather than running off them.
- 4 Off the heat, stir in the lemon zest and juice and most of the cheese. Taste and season — tinned beans need more salt than you expect.
- 5 Serve straight from the pan with the rest of the cheese, a thread of oil and plenty of black pepper.

SWAP

Butter beans or borlotti both work. Spinach instead of kale needs only 30 seconds at step 2.

BULK IT OUT

Spoon over toasted sourdough rubbed with a raw garlic clove, or top with a fried egg.

MAKE IT FASTER

Use bagged shredded kale and you are down to 2 minutes of prep.

LEFTOVERS

Better on day two, once the rosemary has settled in. Keeps 4 days chilled; loosen with water.

350 kcal
CALORIES

16 g
PROTEIN

25 g
CARBS

20 g
FAT

9 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one chopping board, one grater.

32 Tuna Puttanesca Beans



ONE PAN

ITALIAN

4 PREP / 8 COOK

SERVES 4

Everything comes out of a tin or a jar, and eight minutes later it tastes like it took an hour.

INGREDIENTS

- 3 tbsp (45 ml) olive oil
- 4 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 4 anchovy fillets in olive oil
- ½ tsp chilli flakes
- 1 × 400 g (14 oz) tin cherry or chopped tomatoes
- 2 tbsp capers, rinsed
- 100 g (¾ cup) black olives, torn off their stones
- 1 tsp dried oregano
- 2 × 400 g (14 oz) tins butter beans, drained
- 2 × 160 g (5½ oz) tins tuna in olive oil, drained
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, chopped
- 1 lemon
- Black pepper

WHY IT WORKS

Starting the garlic and anchovies in cold oil over gentle heat lets them infuse as the pan comes up, instead of scorching the moment they land. The tuna goes in off the heat and gets folded once — stir it twice and it shreds into the sauce and disappears.

METHOD

- 1 Put the oil, garlic, anchovies and chilli into a cold frying pan and set it over medium heat. Cook 2 minutes as it warms, pressing the anchovies until they collapse and the garlic sizzles pale gold.
- 2 Add the tomatoes, capers, olives and oregano. Simmer hard 4 minutes, until the sauce darkens a shade and pulls away from the side of the pan when you push it.
- 3 Stir in the beans with 50 ml (3 tbsp) water and warm through for 2 minutes, so they take on the sauce without breaking up.
- 4 Take the pan off the heat. Flake the tuna over the top in large pieces and fold it through once, no more.
- 5 Finish with parsley, a good squeeze of lemon and black pepper. It needs no salt — the anchovies, capers and olives have done that job.

SWAP

Tinned sardines or mackerel in place of tuna. Cannellini or chickpeas for the butter beans.

BULK IT OUT

Fold through cooked penne, or pile onto toasted sourdough.

MAKE IT FASTER

Buy pitted olives, though torn olives off the stone taste better.

LEFTOVERS

Excellent cold, straight from the fridge, on toast. Keeps 3 days chilled.

345 kcal
CALORIES

25 g
PROTEIN

23 g
CARBS

16 g
FAT

8 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one sieve, one chopping board.

33 Gambas al Ajillo with Chickpeas

12
MIN

🍳 ONE PAN

SPANISH — 4 PREP / 8 COOK — SERVES 4

Sliced garlic brought up slowly in a lot of olive oil, then chickpeas blistered in it and prawns cooked for barely two minutes.

INGREDIENTS

- 75 ml (5 tbsp) olive oil
- 8 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 2 dried guindilla chillies, snapped in half (or 1 tsp chilli flakes)
- 2 × 400 g (14 oz) tins chickpeas, drained and patted dry
- 1 tsp sweet smoked paprika
- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) raw king prawns, peeled
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) dry sherry or dry white wine
- 1 lemon
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, chopped
- Flaky sea salt

WHY IT WORKS

Garlic goes into cold oil and heats with the pan, so it perfumes the whole lot on the way up instead of burning in the first thirty seconds. Drying the chickpeas before they hit the oil is what lets them blister and take on colour rather than steam in their own moisture.

METHOD

- 1 Put the oil, garlic and chilli into a cold, wide frying pan and set it over medium heat. Let it come up slowly for 3 minutes, until the garlic is the colour of straw and the oil smells sweet. Starting cold is what stops it catching.
- 2 Add the chickpeas, paprika and a pinch of salt. Fry 3 minutes, pressing some against the pan base with the back of a spoon, until their skins blister and split.
- 3 Lay the prawns in one layer and salt them. Cook 1 minute, turn, then 1 minute more — they are done the moment they turn pink and curl loosely. Any longer and they tighten.
- 4 Pour in the sherry. Let it hiss and reduce for 30 seconds, scraping the base so nothing is left behind.
- 5 Off the heat, add a good squeeze of lemon, the parsley and flaky salt. Bring the pan to the table while the oil is still bubbling at the edges.

SWAP

Squid rings instead of prawns — 90 seconds, no more. Butter beans in place of chickpeas.

BULK IT OUT

Bread is the point here — plenty of it, for the garlic oil left in the pan.

MAKE IT FASTER

Peeled prawns and drained chickpeas straight from the fridge takes prep to 2 minutes.

LEFTOVERS

The chickpeas keep 3 days and are good cold. Eat the prawns the same day.

455 kcal
CALORIES

36 g
PROTEIN

31 g
CARBS

20 g
FAT

9 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one sieve, one chopping board.

34 Smoky Paprika Chicken with Piquillo Peppers

18
MIN

🍲 ONE PAN

SPANISH — 6 PREP / 12 COOK — SERVES 4

Chicken thighs rubbed with two kinds of pimentón, browned hard, then loosened with sherry vinegar and torn piquillo peppers.

INGREDIENTS

- 700 g (1 lb 9 oz) boneless, skinless chicken thighs, cut into 3 cm pieces
- 1 tsp sweet smoked paprika
- ½ tsp hot smoked paprika
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) olive oil
- 1 red onion, sliced
- 4 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 1 bay leaf
- 220 g (8 oz) drained piquillo peppers, torn into strips
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) sherry vinegar
- 100 ml (scant ½ cup) good chicken stock
- 30 g (¼ cup) almonds, toasted and roughly chopped
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, chopped
- Salt and black pepper

WHY IT WORKS

Thigh meat browns without drying out, so you can leave it alone on high heat for four minutes and build real colour on the pan base. Sherry vinegar then lifts all of that into the sauce in seconds, doing the work a long braise would otherwise be needed for.

METHOD

- 1 Toss the chicken on the board with both paprikas, a good pinch of salt and plenty of pepper until every piece is coated rust red.
- 2 Heat the oil in a large frying pan over high. Add the chicken in one layer and leave it alone for 4 minutes — moving it early costs you the crust. Turn and cook 2 minutes more.
- 3 Drop the heat to medium and add the onion, garlic and bay. Cook 3 minutes, until the onion softens at the edges but keeps some bite.
- 4 Add the peppers and vinegar, scraping the base clean as it bubbles. Pour in the stock and simmer 3 minutes, until it reduces to a glossy coating and the thickest piece of chicken shows no pink at the centre.
- 5 Off the heat, scatter with almonds and parsley. Taste, and add another splash of vinegar if it needs sharpening.

SWAP

Roasted red peppers from a jar if you cannot find piquillos. Chickpeas make it meat-free.

BULK IT OUT

Serve with bread, or stir in a drained tin of white beans with the stock.

MAKE IT FASTER

Ask the butcher to dice the thighs, or buy them ready-cut.

LEFTOVERS

Keeps 3 days chilled and reheats well. The paprika deepens overnight.

380 kcal
CALORIES

34 g
PROTEIN

10 g
CARBS

22 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one chopping board.

35 Chipotle Black Bean & Charred Corn Skillet



ONE PAN

MEXICAN — 5 PREP / 10 COOK — SERVES 4

Frozen corn hits a dry, smoking pan and blackens in three minutes flat. That char is the whole dish.

INGREDIENTS

- 400 g (14 oz) frozen sweetcorn
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) olive oil
- 1 red onion, finely diced
- 3 garlic cloves, sliced
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- 1 tsp dried oregano
- 2 chipotle chillies in adobo, chopped, plus 1 tbsp of their sauce
- 2 × 400 g (14 oz) tins black beans, drained but not rinsed
- 400 g (14 oz) tin chopped tomatoes
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- 1 lime, halved
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) coriander, roughly chopped
- 100 g (3½ oz) feta, crumbled, or 1 avocado, sliced

WHY IT WORKS

Corn browns before it properly thaws, so it goes into a bare pan first and takes its char while everything else waits on the board. The beans arrive already cooked, so the pan only has to warm them while the chipotle and their starchy liquor thicken to a sauce.

METHOD

- 1 Put a large frying pan over your highest heat with nothing in it. When it smokes faintly, tip in the frozen corn and spread it flat. Leave it 3 minutes, then stir once — you want blistered black patches, not even colour. Scrape into a bowl.
- 2 Add the oil, onion and a pinch of salt to the same pan. Fry 2 minutes, until the edges soften and colour.
- 3 Stir in the garlic, cumin, oregano and chipotle. Thirty seconds, until the spices smell toasted rather than raw.
- 4 Tip in the beans and tomatoes, season, and simmer hard for 4 minutes, crushing a few spoonfuls against the side of the pan. It is ready when a spoon dragged through leaves a clear channel for a second.
- 5 Fold the corn back through, squeeze over half the lime and taste for salt. Scatter with coriander and feta, and cut the rest into wedges.

SWAP

Pinto or kidney beans behave the same. No chipotle — 2 tsp smoked paprika and a pinch of cayenne gets you close.

BULK IT OUT

Warm corn tortillas in the empty pan afterwards, or spoon it over baked sweet potatoes.

MAKE IT FASTER

Char the corn while you dice the onion — it does not need watching.

LEFTOVERS

Four days chilled, better on day two. Reheats with a splash of water.

420 kcal
CALORIES

16 g
PROTEIN

52 g
CARBS

16 g
FAT

14 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one bowl, one chopping board.

36 Lomo Saltado



PERUVIAN — 6 PREP / 9 COOK — SERVES 4

15
MIN

Beef, onion and tomato seared hard in a wok, splashed with vinegar and soy, with the chips folded straight back in.

INGREDIENTS

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) waxy potatoes, cut into 1 cm (½ in) chips
- 500 g (1 lb 2 oz) beef sirloin or rump, cut into finger-thick strips
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) groundnut or sunflower oil
- 1 large red onion, cut into thick wedges
- 3 tomatoes, cut into wedges
- 1 red chilli, sliced, or 1 tbsp aji amarillo paste
- 3 garlic cloves, sliced
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) soy sauce
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) red wine vinegar
- ½ tsp coarsely ground black pepper
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) coriander, roughly chopped

WHY IT WORKS

The wok has to be properly hot and the beef dry and in one layer, or it steams grey instead of browning. Microwaving the potatoes while you slice everything means they need two minutes in hot oil to crisp rather than a full deep-fry.

METHOD

- 1 Put the potatoes in a bowl with a splash of water, cover, and microwave on full for 6 minutes while you slice everything else. Drain and pat dry — dry chips crisp, wet ones spit.
- 2 Heat 2 tbsp of the oil in a wok until it shimmers. Fry the potatoes 3 minutes, turning twice, until golden and crisp on two sides. Tip them back into the bowl.
- 3 Add the last tablespoon of oil and the beef, spread flat. Leave 60 seconds undisturbed for a crust, then toss a minute more. Push it up the side of the wok.
- 4 Throw the onion, chilli and garlic into the base. Two minutes on high — smoky at the edges, still snapping in the middle.
- 5 Add the tomatoes, soy, vinegar and pepper. Toss for 1 minute, until the tomatoes slump and the liquid turns glossy and clings to the beef rather than pooling.
- 6 Fold the potatoes back in with the coriander and serve straight from the wok.

SWAP

Skirt or bavette, sliced across the grain. Thick portobello strips make a good meat-free version.

BULK IT OUT

White rice alongside is traditional and soaks up what the potatoes miss.

MAKE IT FASTER

Freeze the beef 15 minutes first and it slices cleanly in half the time.

LEFTOVERS

Two days chilled. The chips soften, so reheat hard in the wok, never the microwave.

465 kcal
CALORIES

37 g
PROTEIN

37 g
CARBS

19 g
FAT

5 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One wok, one bowl, one chopping board.

37 Moqueca Express — Brazilian Coconut Fish Stew

18
MIN

🍲 ONE PAN

BRAZILIAN — 6 PREP / 12 COOK — SERVES 4

Chunks of white fish dropped into a coconut and pepper broth and left completely alone until they turn opaque.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASE

- 2 tbsp (30 ml) olive oil or red palm oil
- 1 onion, finely sliced
- 1 red and 1 yellow pepper, sliced
- 4 garlic cloves, sliced
- 1 tsp sweet paprika
- 2 tomatoes, chopped
- 400 ml (1⅔ cups) tin full-fat coconut milk

FOR THE FISH AND FINISHING

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) firm white fish (cod, hake or monkfish), cut into 4 cm (1½ in) chunks
- 1 lime — juice of half, the rest in wedges
- ¾ tsp fine sea salt
- 1 red chilli, sliced
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) coriander, stalks chopped, leaves left whole

WHY IT WORKS

The fish goes in last and is never stirred, so it poaches in the coconut milk and holds together in proper chunks. Salting it with lime while you build the base draws out surface water and firms the flesh, which is the difference between chunks and flakes.

METHOD

- 1 Toss the fish with the lime juice and salt in a bowl and leave it while you cook the base.
- 2 Heat the oil in a wide, deep frying pan. Cook the onion and peppers over a medium-high heat for 5 minutes, until floppy and colouring at the edges.
- 3 Add the garlic, paprika and coriander stalks, stir 1 minute, then the tomatoes for 2 minutes more, pressing them down until they collapse.
- 4 Pour in the coconut milk, bring to a bare simmer and season. Bubble gently 2 minutes to thicken.
- 5 Slide the fish in in one layer, spoon sauce over the top, and cover. Cook 4 minutes without stirring. It is done when the chunks are opaque to the centre and part easily under a spoon.
- 6 Scatter with chilli and coriander leaves and serve from the pan with lime wedges.

SWAP

Raw prawns need 3 minutes, not 4. Firm tofu works, as does butternut given 8 minutes before the coconut milk goes in.

BULK IT OUT

Plain rice, or toasted cassava flour scattered over if you can find it.

MAKE IT FASTER

Frozen sliced peppers go in straight from the bag.

LEFTOVERS

Two days chilled. Reheat gently — a hard boil breaks the fish up.

400 kcal
CALORIES

31 g
PROTEIN

13 g
CARBS

25 g
FAT

4 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One deep frying pan with a lid, one bowl, one chopping board.

38 Filipino Adobo Flash Chicken

18
MIN



ONE PAN

FILIPINO

— 5 PREP / 13 COOK —

SERVES 4

All the salt, sour and garlic of a long-braised adobo, done in the time it takes thin-sliced thigh to cook through.

INGREDIENTS

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) boneless, skinless chicken thighs, sliced 1 cm (½ in) thick
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) groundnut or sunflower oil
- 8 garlic cloves, crushed flat but left whole
- 100 ml (scant ½ cup) cane or white wine vinegar
- 75 ml (⅓ cup) soy sauce
- 100 ml (scant ½ cup) water
- 3 bay leaves
- 1 tsp black peppercorns, cracked under the base of a pan
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) honey
- 200 g (7 oz) green beans, or 2 heads pak choi, halved
- 2 spring onions, sliced

WHY IT WORKS

Adobo is normally a slow braise because the vinegar needs time to lose its raw edge. Slicing the thighs thin gives far more surface area, so the same soy-and-vinegar liquid reduces to a syrup in minutes and coats the meat rather than stewing it.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the oil in a large frying pan over a high heat. Lay the chicken in one layer, leave it 3 minutes to brown, then turn and give it a minute more.
- 2 Push the chicken aside, drop the garlic into the clear space and fry 45 seconds, until it smells sweet and looks pale gold. Do not let it darken, or the sauce turns bitter.
- 3 Pour in the vinegar and boil hard for 1 minute with the extractor on — this cooks off the sharpest edge.
- 4 Add the soy, water, bay and peppercorns. Simmer briskly for 6 minutes, turning the chicken once or twice.
- 5 Stir in the honey, add the greens, and cook 2 minutes more. It is ready when the sauce is dark and just coats a spoon, and the beans still squeak against your teeth.
- 6 Scatter with spring onion and serve, spooning the reduced sauce over everything.

SWAP

Drumsticks need 25 minutes, so stay with thighs midweek. Whole chestnut mushrooms take the sauce well in 8 minutes.

BULK IT OUT

Rice is not optional here, and it should be plain.

MAKE IT FASTER

Crush the garlic under the flat of a knife instead of chopping — the skins slip off and the cloves stay whole in the pan.

LEFTOVERS

Genuinely better after a night in the fridge. Keeps 3 days chilled.

335 kcal
CALORIES

30 g
PROTEIN

10 g
CARBS

19 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one chopping board.

39 Nasi Goreng Cauliflower Rice with Fried Egg

15
MIN



INDONESIAN — 5 PREP / 10 COOK — SERVES 4

Cauliflower rice, sambal and prawns fried hot and fast, with a crisp-edged egg on every plate.

INGREDIENTS

- 3 tbsp (45 ml) groundnut or sunflower oil
- 4 shallots, finely chopped
- 4 garlic cloves, finely chopped
- 2 tbsp sambal oelek
- 250 g (9 oz) raw peeled prawns
- 800 g (1 lb 12 oz) cauliflower rice
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) soy sauce
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) honey
- 4 eggs
- ½ cucumber, sliced
- 2 tomatoes, cut into wedges
- 2 spring onions, sliced
- 1 lime, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Cauliflower rice releases water the moment it meets heat, so the wok must be hot enough to drive it off as steam — crowd it or drop the heat and you get porridge. Frying the shallots, garlic and sambal in oil first, before anything wet arrives, is what gives the dish depth.

METHOD

- 1 Heat 2 tbsp of the oil in a wok over a high heat. Fry the shallots and garlic 2 minutes, until deep gold at the edges, then stir in the sambal for 1 minute more — it should darken and smell toasted rather than sharp.
- 2 Add the prawns and toss 90 seconds, until just pink and curled into loose Cs. Tip the lot into a bowl.
- 3 Turn the heat as high as it goes and add the cauliflower rice in two batches, tossing constantly for 3 minutes in total. Listen to it: a steady sizzle means the water is going, silence means it is stewing.
- 4 Return the prawn mixture with the soy and honey and toss 1 minute, until every grain is coloured and the wok is dry again. Divide between plates.
- 5 Wipe the wok, add the last tablespoon of oil and fry the eggs over a high heat for 2 minutes, until the whites are lacy and brown at the rim, the yolks still running.
- 6 Sit an egg on each plate and add cucumber, tomato, spring onion and a lime wedge.

SWAP

Diced chicken thigh instead of prawns needs 4 minutes. Leave both out for 200 g of firm tofu cubes.

BULK IT OUT

Half cauliflower rice, half cold jasmine rice from the day before.

MAKE IT FASTER

Frozen cauliflower rice goes in from the freezer and wants one extra minute.

LEFTOVERS

Two days chilled, but fry the eggs fresh each time.

315 kcal
CALORIES

24 g
PROTEIN

14 g
CARBS

17 g
FAT

5 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One wok, one bowl, one chopping board.

40 Sambal Green Beans with Egg

WOK

MALAYSIAN — 4 PREP / 8 COOK — SERVES 4

12
MIN

Beans blistered in a dry wok, then tossed through a sweet-sour sambal with soft-set egg clinging to them.

INGREDIENTS

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) green beans, topped and halved
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) groundnut or sunflower oil
- 4 shallots, finely sliced
- 4 garlic cloves, finely chopped
- 2 tbsp sambal oelek
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) tamarind paste, or the juice of 1 lime
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) honey
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) fish sauce
- 6 eggs, beaten with a pinch of salt
- 60 g (½ cup) unsalted roasted peanuts, roughly crushed
- 1 lime, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Dry-frying the beans before any oil goes in blisters the skins and collapses them just enough to take on sauce; a wet pan only steams them limp. The egg goes in at the end onto a hot, clear patch of wok, so it sets on contact and wraps the beans instead of scrambling into curds.

METHOD

- 1 Put the wok over your highest heat, dry. Add the beans and toss every 30 seconds for 3 minutes, until streaked brown and beginning to wrinkle. Tip them into a bowl.
- 2 Add 2 tbsp of the oil, then the shallots and garlic, and fry 90 seconds until golden and fragrant.
- 3 Stir in the sambal and fry 1 minute — it should deepen in colour and the oil separate slightly at the edges.
- 4 Add the tamarind, honey and fish sauce, then return the beans. Toss 1 minute, until every bean is coated and glossy.
- 5 Push everything aside, add the last tablespoon of oil to the clear space and pour in the eggs. Count to twenty while they set at the base, then fold the beans through in big slow strokes. Take the wok off the heat while the egg still looks wet — it carries on cooking.
- 6 Scatter with the crushed peanuts and serve with lime wedges.

SWAP

Long beans, sugar snaps or tenderstem broccoli all dry-fry the same way. Cashews instead of peanuts.

BULK IT OUT

Rice, or fold 200 g of cooked rice noodles through at step 4.

MAKE IT FASTER

Beat the eggs in the bowl the beans are resting in and save a wash.

LEFTOVERS

Two days chilled. Eat it at room temperature — reheating toughens the egg.

385 kcal
CALORIES

17 g
PROTEIN

19 g
CARBS

26 g
FAT

6 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One wok, one bowl, one chopping board.

41 Burmese Golden Turmeric Chicken



ONE PAN

BURMESE — 5 PREP / 10 COOK — SERVES 4

Onions cooked down in turmeric oil until the fat itself turns orange, with thin-sliced chicken finished in the same slick.

INGREDIENTS

- 3 tbsp (45 ml) groundnut oil
- 2 onions, finely sliced
- 6 garlic cloves, finely chopped
- 4 cm (1½ in) ginger, finely chopped
- 2 tsp ground turmeric
- 1 tsp paprika
- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) boneless, skinless chicken thighs, sliced 1 cm (½ in) thick
- 3 tomatoes, chopped
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) fish sauce
- 100 ml (scant ½ cup) good chicken stock
- 1 red chilli, sliced
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) coriander, roughly chopped
- 1 lime, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Burmese cooking builds its base by frying onion, garlic and turmeric in more oil than feels sensible, until the oil takes on colour and separates — that stained oil is the sauce. Slicing the thighs thin means the chicken cooks through in the four minutes the onions need to soften.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the oil in a large frying pan over a medium-high heat. Add the onions with a pinch of salt and fry 4 minutes, stirring, until soft and browning at the tips.
- 2 Add the garlic, ginger, turmeric and paprika and stir 1 minute. The oil should turn deep orange and the dusty, raw smell of the turmeric disappear.
- 3 Turn the heat up, add the chicken and toss until every piece is coated in the golden oil. Spread it flat and leave it 2 minutes.
- 4 Add the tomatoes, fish sauce and stock. Simmer 3 minutes, pressing the tomatoes down as they soften, until the sauce is thick enough to sit on the chicken and the oil pools orange at the sides.
- 5 Check the thickest slice — white through, no pink at the centre. Scatter with chilli and coriander and serve with lime wedges.

SWAP

Chicken breast works, sliced thinner, with the simmer dropped to 2 minutes. White fish chunks need only 3 minutes in total.

BULK IT OUT

Plain rice, or rice noodles dropped into the sauce for the last 2 minutes.

MAKE IT FASTER

Grate the garlic and ginger into the pan on a microplane instead of chopping.

LEFTOVERS

Three days chilled. The turmeric oil sets on top as a bright orange cap — stir it back through as it reheats.

400 kcal
CALORIES

30 g
PROTEIN

11 g
CARBS

26 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one chopping board.

42 Ethiopian Gomen with Spiced Eggs

15
MIN



ONE PAN

ETHIOPIAN — 4 PREP / 11 COOK — SERVES 4

Greens braised soft with ginger and berbere, with eggs cracked into wells in the pan and lidded until just set.

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp (30 ml) olive oil or ghee
- 1 onion, finely sliced
- 4 garlic cloves, finely chopped
- 4 cm (1½ in) ginger, finely chopped
- 2 tsp berbere, plus a pinch to finish
- 500 g (1 lb 2 oz) kale or collard greens, stalks stripped, leaves finely shredded
- 2 tomatoes, chopped
- 150 ml (⅔ cup) water
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- 8 eggs
- 1 lemon, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Gomen is traditionally collards cooked for an hour, but shredding kale finely across the leaf gets the same silky texture in eight minutes, because all those cut edges take up water fast. Berbere needs a moment in hot fat before any liquid arrives, or it stays gritty and tastes only of heat.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the oil in a large frying pan over a medium-high heat and fry the onion 3 minutes, until translucent and catching at the edges.
- 2 Add the garlic, ginger and berbere and stir 45 seconds. The fat should turn brick red and the spice smell sweet and toasted rather than sharp.
- 3 Pile in the kale with the tomatoes, water and salt. It will look like far too much; press it under a lid for 30 seconds and it collapses to a third.
- 4 Cook uncovered 5 minutes, stirring twice, until the greens are dark and glossy, tender enough to cut with the side of a spoon, and the water has gone.
- 5 Make eight shallow wells with the back of the spoon and crack an egg into each. Season, cover, and cook 3 minutes for runny yolks, 4 for set.
- 6 Finish with a pinch more berbere and serve from the pan with lemon wedges.

SWAP

Cavolo nero, spring greens or chard all work — chard needs only 3 minutes. No berbere: 1 tsp paprika, ½ tsp chilli, ½ tsp fenugreek, a pinch of cinnamon.

BULK IT OUT

Injera if you have it, flatbread if not, or a drained tin of chickpeas added at step 3.

MAKE IT FASTER

Bagged shredded kale skips the stripping and shredding entirely.

LEFTOVERS

The greens keep 3 days chilled and reheat well. Cook the eggs to order.

300 kcal
CALORIES

18 g
PROTEIN

13 g
CARBS

19 g
FAT

5 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan with a lid, one chopping board.

43 Ras el Hanout Turkey with Herbs & Almonds



🍲 ONE PAN

MOROCCAN — 5 PREP / 10 COOK — SERVES 4

Turkey mince seared hard, spiced while it sizzles, then cooled with lemon, chickpeas and a fistful of herbs.

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tbsp (30 ml) olive oil
- 500 g (1 lb 2 oz) turkey mince
- 1 red onion, finely sliced
- 2 garlic cloves, sliced
- 2 tsp ras el hanout
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- 400 g (14 oz) tin chickpeas, drained
- 60 g (½ cup) whole almonds, roughly chopped
- 1 lemon — zest and juice
- 30 g (¾ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley and coriander, roughly chopped
- 100 g (⅓ cup) thick Greek yoghurt, to serve

WHY IT WORKS

Turkey mince is lean enough to sear rather than stew, so pressing it flat and leaving it alone for two minutes builds a browned crust that stands in for a long-cooked base. The ras el hanout goes in after the browning, into hot fat, where thirty seconds is enough to bloom it without scorching the ground ginger and cinnamon in the blend.

METHOD

- 1 Get a large frying pan properly hot over a high heat. Add half the oil, then the mince in one layer. Press it flat and leave it undisturbed for 2 minutes — you want a brown crust before you break it up.
- 2 Break the mince into rough clumps, push it to one side and add the rest of the oil with the onion and garlic. Cook for 3 minutes, until the onion is slack and translucent at the edges.
- 3 Scatter over the ras el hanout and salt and stir everything together for 30 seconds, until the pan smells warm and resinous.
- 4 Add the chickpeas and almonds and cook 3 minutes more, stirring twice, until the chickpeas take colour and the almonds smell toasted.
- 5 Off the heat, stir through the lemon zest and juice and most of the herbs. Taste for salt — turkey needs more than you expect.
- 6 Spoon onto plates with the yoghurt and the remaining herbs.

SWAP

Chicken mince behaves identically. Lamb is richer — pour off some fat before the spices go in.

BULK IT OUT

Couscous steeped in boiling water for 5 minutes, or flatbread torn into the pan.

MAKE IT FASTER

Skip the onion and grate in a shallot; it softens in under a minute.

LEFTOVERS

Three days chilled. Good cold in pitta with more yoghurt and lemon.

410 kcal
CALORIES

36 g
PROTEIN

14 g
CARBS

23 g
FAT

6 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one chopping board, one wooden spoon.

44 West African Peanut Stew Express

20
MIN



ONE PAN

GHANAIAN / SENEGALESE — 6 PREP / 14 COOK — SERVES 4

Coarsely grated sweet potato melts into peanut butter and tomato in a quarter of the usual time.

INGREDIENTS

- 1 tbsp (15 ml) groundnut or olive oil
- 500 g (1 lb 2 oz) boneless chicken thighs, cut into 2 cm ($\frac{3}{4}$ in) pieces
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, grated
- 20 g ($\frac{1}{2}$ tbsp) fresh ginger, grated
- 1 scotch bonnet or red chilli, deseeded and chopped
- 1 tsp ground coriander
- 400 g (14 oz) tin chopped tomatoes
- 400 ml ($1\frac{2}{3}$ cups) chicken stock or water
- 400 g (14 oz) sweet potato, coarsely grated, skin on
- 120 g ($\frac{1}{2}$ cup) smooth 100% peanut butter
- 200 g (7 oz) spinach
- 30 g ($\frac{1}{4}$ cup) roasted peanuts, roughly chopped
- 1 lime, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Grating the sweet potato rather than cubing it takes the cooking time from forty minutes to eight — the shreds collapse and thicken the stew from the inside, doing the job a long simmer normally does. The peanut butter goes in late, loosened with a ladle of hot liquid first, because it splits and turns grainy if it catches on the base of the pan.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the oil in a wide, deep pan over a high heat. Brown the chicken in one layer for 3 minutes without stirring, then turn once.
- 2 Add the onion, garlic, ginger, chilli and ground coriander. Cook 2 minutes, until the pan smells sharp and sweet at once.
- 3 Tip in the tomatoes, stock and sweet potato. Bring to the boil, then simmer briskly for 8 minutes. The shreds should vanish into the sauce and the liquid should coat a spoon.
- 4 Drop the heat to low. Stir the peanut butter into a ladleful of the hot liquid in a mug, then pour it back — it emulsifies smoothly instead of clumping.
- 5 Add the spinach in handfuls, stirring until just wilted, about 1 minute. Salt to taste.
- 6 Serve with the peanuts scattered over and lime wedges to squeeze.

SWAP

Two tins of drained chickpeas instead of chicken; add them at step 3.

BULK IT OUT

Steamed rice, or fufu if you have it.

MAKE IT FASTER

Grate the sweet potato in a food processor while the chicken browns.

LEFTOVERS

Four days chilled, better on day two. Loosen with water when reheating.

485 kcal
CALORIES

33 g
PROTEIN

27 g
CARBS

27 g
FAT

6 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One deep pan, one chopping board, one box grater, one mug.

45 Georgian Walnut-Garlic Green Beans with Eggs

15
MIN

🍳 ONE PAN

GEORGIAN — 6 PREP / 9 COOK — SERVES 4

Blanched beans in a raw walnut and garlic paste, with fried eggs on top so the yolks run into it.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BEANS

- 500 g (1 lb 2 oz) green beans, topped
- 8 eggs
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) olive oil

FOR THE WALNUT SAUCE

- 100 g (1 cup) walnut halves
- 2 garlic cloves
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) red wine vinegar
- ½ tsp ground coriander
- ¼ tsp ground fenugreek, blue fenugreek if you have it
- ¼ tsp cayenne or hot paprika, plus a pinch to finish
- 15 g (½ cup, packed) coriander leaves, plus more to serve
- ½ tsp fine sea salt

WHY IT WORKS

Walnuts blitzed with garlic, vinegar and a splash of the bean cooking water make an instant emulsion — the nut oil and starchy water hold together the way a tahini sauce does, with no cooking at all. Blanching the beans for four minutes and running them under the cold tap stops them going khaki and keeps the squeak.

METHOD

- 1 Bring a wide pan of well-salted water to the boil. Add the beans and cook 4 minutes — they should bend without snapping and still squeak against the teeth.
- 2 Meanwhile, put the walnuts, garlic, vinegar, spices, coriander and salt into a small blender or mortar and work to a coarse, sandy paste.
- 3 Scoop out 100 ml (scant ½ cup) of the bean water. Drain, run the beans under the cold tap for 20 seconds, then tip them into a serving bowl.
- 4 Loosen the paste with the reserved water a splash at a time until it falls from the spoon like thick double cream, then fold it through the warm beans.
- 5 Dry the pan, set it back over a medium-high heat with the oil and fry the eggs for 2 to 3 minutes, until the whites are set and lacy at the edges but the yolks still move.
- 6 Sit two eggs on each bowlful, finish with coriander and a pinch of cayenne.

SWAP

Runner beans, broccoli or cooked beetroot take the same sauce — the pkhali principle.

BULK IT OUT

Warm flatbread, or a drained tin of butter beans folded in at step 4.

MAKE IT FASTER

Pound the sauce while the water comes up; it is done before the beans are.

LEFTOVERS

The dressed beans keep 3 days chilled. Fry eggs fresh each time.

360 kcal
CALORIES

19 g
PROTEIN

7 g
CARBS

28 g
FAT

6 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One pan, one chopping board, one blender jug, one serving bowl.

46 Deconstructed Vietnamese Summer Roll Bowl

15
MIN

🍴 NO COOK

VIETNAMESE — 15 PREP / 0 COOK — SERVES 4

Everything that goes inside a summer roll, without the wrapper wrestling. The kettle is the only heat.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BOWLS

- 200 g (7 oz) fine rice vermicelli
- 400 g (14 oz) firm tofu, drained and cut into 1 cm (½ in) slabs
- 1 cucumber, halved and cut into matchsticks
- 2 carrots, coarsely grated
- 1 baby gem lettuce, shredded
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) mint leaves
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) coriander
- a handful of Thai basil, if you can find it
- 60 g (½ cup) roasted peanuts, roughly crushed

FOR THE NUOC CHAM

- 3 tbsp (45 ml) fish sauce
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) lime juice, about 2 limes
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) warm water
- 1½ tbsp honey
- 2 garlic cloves, grated
- 1 red chilli, finely sliced

WHY IT WORKS

Fine rice vermicelli is thin enough to soften right through in off-the-boil kettle water in six minutes, so the hob stays cold. Nuoc cham is a ratio rather than a recipe — equal parts fish sauce, lime and water, half as much honey — so you can taste and correct it in the bowl you serve from.

METHOD

- 1 Boil the kettle. Put the vermicelli in a large bowl, cover with hot water by 2 cm (¾ in) and leave 6 minutes.
- 2 Meanwhile whisk the nuoc cham in the serving bowl until the honey dissolves. Taste: sharp first, salty second, barely sweet.
- 3 Cut the vegetables and pick the herbs on one board, leaves whole so they stay springy.
- 4 Drain the noodles and rinse under the cold tap until cool and no longer tacky — this is what stops them setting into a brick.
- 5 Turn the tofu in 2 tbsp of the dressing and leave 2 minutes; it takes the liquid up like a sponge.
- 6 Divide the noodles between four bowls, pile on vegetables, herbs and tofu, spoon over the rest of the dressing, finish with peanuts.

SWAP

300 g cooked cold king prawns or shredded poached chicken in place of the tofu.

BULK IT OUT

A second block of tofu, or half an avocado per person.

MAKE IT FASTER

Put carrot and cucumber through the same box grater and skip the knife.

LEFTOVERS

Keep the dressing separate and it holds 2 days. Dressed noodles go soft overnight.

440 kcal
CALORIES

22 g
PROTEIN

52 g
CARBS

16 g
FAT

6 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One large bowl, one serving bowl, one chopping board, one box grater.

47 Fattoush with Crisped Chickpeas



🌿 NO COOK

LEBANESE — 15 PREP / 0 COOK — SERVES 4

The crunch normally comes from fried bread; here it comes from chickpeas rubbed out of their skins and air-dried while you chop.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE SALAD

- 2 × 400 g (14 oz) tins chickpeas, drained
- 2 tsp sumac, plus a pinch to finish
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) extra virgin olive oil
- 400 g (14 oz) ripe tomatoes, cut into rough chunks
- 1 cucumber, halved and thickly sliced
- 6 radishes, quartered
- 4 spring onions, sliced
- 2 baby gem lettuces, torn
- 30 g (¼ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, chopped
- 15 g (⅓ cup, packed) mint leaves
- 40 g (⅓ cup) toasted pine nuts

FOR THE DRESSING

- juice of 1½ lemons
- 1 garlic clove, grated
- 1 tbsp pomegranate molasses
- 1 tsp sumac
- ½ tsp fine sea salt

WHY IT WORKS

Chickpea skins trap water and go slippery in dressing, so rubbing the drained tins in a tea towel, tipping the skins away and leaving the bare chickpeas to dry with salt and sumac for ten minutes gives a firm, nubby bite with no pan involved. Salting the tomatoes meanwhile does the opposite job on purpose — the juice they give up becomes half the dressing.

METHOD

- 1 Tip the chickpeas onto a clean tea towel, fold it over and rub firmly for 20 seconds. Open it out, pick away the loose skins.
- 2 Spread them on a plate, scatter over 2 tsp sumac, a pinch of salt and 1 tbsp oil, and leave uncovered while you do everything else.
- 3 Put the tomatoes in the serving bowl with a good pinch of salt; within two minutes they weep.
- 4 Whisk the dressing and the remaining 2 tbsp oil straight into the tomatoes and their juice.
- 5 Add the cucumber, radishes, spring onions, lettuce and herbs and turn it by hand twice, no more — fattoush bruises if you work it.
- 6 Fold through most of the chickpeas, scatter the rest over with the pine nuts and more sumac.

SWAP

Butter beans instead of chickpeas — no skinning, just thorough drying.

BULK IT OUT

200 g crumbled feta, or a tin of tuna in olive oil.

MAKE IT FASTER

Skip the skinning and pat the chickpeas bone dry. Less crunch, four minutes saved.

LEFTOVERS

Best within the hour. To keep it, hold back the lettuce and herbs, add them fresh.

355 kcal
CALORIES

11 g
PROTEIN

32 g
CARBS

20 g
FAT

11 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One serving bowl, one chopping board, one plate, one tea towel.

48 Salmon Poke Bowl

12
MIN

🍴 NO COOK

HAWAIIAN-JAPANESE — 12 PREP / 0 COOK — SERVES 4

A four-ingredient marinade, ten minutes of chopping, and fish that never meets heat at any point.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE FISH

- 500 g (1 lb 2 oz) sashimi-grade salmon, skinned, in 2 cm (¾ in) cubes
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) soy sauce or tamari
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) toasted sesame oil
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) rice vinegar
- 1 tsp honey
- 2 tsp finely grated fresh ginger
- 4 spring onions, finely sliced

FOR THE BOWLS

- ½ small white cabbage, finely shredded
- 1 cucumber, in half-moons
- 2 ripe avocados, sliced
- 6 radishes, thinly sliced
- 1 sheet nori, snipped into strips
- 1 tbsp toasted sesame seeds
- 1 lime, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Because nothing is cooked, the salmon must be sashimi-grade — sold specifically for eating raw, and frozen beforehand to kill parasites. Cutting it into 2 cm cubes rather than thin slices gives the soy and sesame more surface to cling to while leaving a centre that stays silky instead of curing firm.

METHOD

- 1 Whisk the soy, sesame oil, vinegar, honey and ginger together in a mixing bowl.
- 2 Add the salmon and half the spring onions and turn them gently through the marinade. Leave 10 minutes while you build the bowls — past 20 the surface goes pale and firm.
- 3 Shred the cabbage and slice the cucumber, avocado and radishes on one board. Divide between four bowls.
- 4 Spoon the salmon and all its marinade over the top.
- 5 Finish with nori strips, sesame seeds, the rest of the spring onion and a lime wedge each.

SWAP

No sashimi-grade fish, no problem. Use 400 g hot-smoked salmon or smoked trout, flaked into large pieces, or cold poached salmon. Halve the soy for either, as both are already salted.

BULK IT OUT

250 g cooked and cooled sushi or brown rice under the salad makes it a proper poke bowl.

MAKE IT FASTER

Ask the fishmonger to skin the fillet and you save three minutes and a sharp knife.

LEFTOVERS

Eat the same day. Raw marinated fish does not keep.

480 kcal
CALORIES

30 g
PROTEIN

11 g
CARBS

36 g
FAT

8 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One mixing bowl, one chopping board, four serving bowls.

49 Prawn Ceviche Tostada Salad



🌿 NO COOK

PERUVIAN-MEXICAN — 15 PREP / 0 COOK — SERVES 4

Built on cooked cold king prawns, so there is no raw-fish window to manage — just lime, chilli and a board full of chopping.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE CEVICHE

- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) cooked cold king prawns, peeled
- juice of 4 limes, about 120 ml (½ cup)
- 1 red onion, very finely sliced
- 1 tbsp aji amarillo paste, or 1 red chilli, chopped
- 1 garlic clove, grated
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) extra virgin olive oil
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- 25 g (⅔ cup, packed) coriander, chopped

TO BUILD

- 8 corn tostadas
- 2 ripe avocados, diced
- 200 g (7 oz) cherry tomatoes, quartered
- 1 cucumber, diced
- 150 g (1 cup) sweetcorn kernels, drained
- 6 radishes, thinly sliced
- 1 lime, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Using cooked cold king prawns means the lime is doing the seasoning rather than the curing, so the salad can stand for ten minutes without the protein going chalky the way raw fish does. Rinsing the sliced red onion under the cold tap for thirty seconds strips out the harshness but leaves the crunch, which is what makes a ceviche taste bright rather than aggressive.

METHOD

- 1 Slice the onion as thinly as you can, put it in a sieve and run cold water over it for 30 seconds. Shake dry.
- 2 In a large bowl, whisk the lime juice, aji amarillo, garlic, oil and salt until the mixture turns slightly cloudy — that cloudiness is the emulsion you want.
- 3 Halve the prawns lengthways if they are large, then fold them in with the onion and leave 10 minutes.
- 4 Add the tomatoes, cucumber, sweetcorn, radishes and most of the coriander, turning gently. Fold the avocado in last so it stays in cubes.
- 5 Pile onto the tostadas at the table — they soften within a couple of minutes of meeting the juice. Serve with the rest of the coriander and lime wedges.

SWAP

Cooked white crab meat or cold poached white fish behave identically. For crunch without tostadas, use 60 g toasted pumpkin seeds.

BULK IT OUT

A drained tin of black beans, or double the sweetcorn.

MAKE IT FASTER

Dice everything to the same size on one board and tip it into the bowl as you go.

LEFTOVERS

The ceviche keeps overnight without the avocado. Never dress the tostadas ahead.

495 kcal
CALORIES

37 g
PROTEIN

37 g
CARBS

22 g
FAT

9 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One large bowl, one chopping board, one sieve.

50 Turkish Çoban Salad with Tuna & Sumac



🍴 NO COOK

TURKISH — 10 PREP / 0 COOK — SERVES 4

Shepherd's salad cut properly small, with the oil from the tuna tin doing half the dressing.

INGREDIENTS

- 3 × 160 g (5½ oz) tins tuna in olive oil
- 500 g (1 lb 2 oz) ripe tomatoes, in 1 cm (½ in) dice
- 1 cucumber, in 1 cm (½ in) dice
- 2 Turkish green peppers or 1 green bell pepper, diced
- ½ red onion, finely diced
- 400 g (14 oz) tin white beans, drained
- 100 g (3½ oz) beyaz peynir or feta, crumbled
- 30 g (¾ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, chopped
- 2 tsp sumac, plus a pinch to finish
- juice of 1 lemon
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) extra virgin olive oil
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) red wine vinegar
- ½ tsp dried mint
- fine sea salt and black pepper

WHY IT WORKS

Çoban salad lives or dies on the size of the dice — everything cut to roughly a centimetre so one forkful carries tomato, cucumber, pepper and onion at once, not one thing at a time. Tuna packed in olive oil brings its own seasoned fat, so tipping the tin in whole rather than draining it saves a step and adds savour.

METHOD

- 1 Put the onion in the serving bowl with the lemon juice, vinegar, sumac, dried mint and a good pinch of salt. Leave it while you chop — ten minutes takes the bite out and turns it pink.
- 2 Dice the tomatoes, cucumber and pepper on one board, small and even, and add them to the bowl with any juice left behind.
- 3 Tip in the tuna and its oil, breaking it into large flakes rather than shredding, then add the beans and the olive oil.
- 4 Fold it over twice with a big spoon. Taste: it should be noticeably sour and properly salted.
- 5 Scatter over the parsley, crumbled cheese and a last pinch of sumac, and take the bowl to the table.

SWAP

Tinned sardines or mackerel in olive oil, or leave the fish out and double the beans and cheese.

BULK IT OUT

Warm pidge for mopping, or bulgur steeped in boiling water for 15 minutes.

MAKE IT FASTER

Leave out the beans and the whole thing lands at seven minutes.

LEFTOVERS

Two days chilled. It weeps, which is fine — the juice at the bottom is the best part.

390 kcal
CALORIES

34 g
PROTEIN

20 g
CARBS

19 g
FAT

7 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One serving bowl, one chopping board, one tin opener.

Breakfast

Savoury more often than sweet, hot more often than cold, and quick enough that eating standing up stops being the only option.

20 RECIPES	19 CUISINES	8 MINUTES, FASTEST	11 UNDER TWELVE MINUTES
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IF YOU ONLY COOK THREE

57 Gyeran Bap — Korean Egg Rice Ten minutes, one pan, and the best argument there is for keeping cooked rice in the fridge.	61 Huevos Rancheros Rápidos Eggs, beans and a charred tomato salsa. Weekend food that happens to take fifteen minutes.	68 Ten-Minute Bircher Muesli Bircher without the overnight wait, because the apple is grated rather than chopped.
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SWEET POTATO, EGG & CHILLI HASH · HALLOUMI, TOMATO & ZA'ATAR PLATE · MASALA OMELETTE MUFFINS · BANANA, OAT & ALMOND BUTTER BAKE · CRISPY CHICKPEA, AVOCADO & LEMON TOAST · TAMAGOYAKI WITH RICE & NORI · GYERAN BAP — KOREAN EGG RICE · TEN-MINUTE GINGER CONGEE · RAVA UTTAPAM WITH COCONUT CHUTNEY · PERSIAN HERB & FETA OMELETTE · HUEVOS RANCHEROS RÁPIDOS · PAN CON TOMATE WITH SOFT EGGS · FUL MEDAMES · BUCKWHEAT GALETTE WITH EGG & GREENS · KHAO TOM — THAI RICE SOUP WITH PRAWNS · EGG & TOMATO STIR-FRY · SINANGAG — FILIPINO GARLIC RICE & EGG · TEN-MINUTE BIRCHER MUESLI · DANISH RYE WITH COTTAGE CHEESE, CUCUMBER & DILL · ORANGE, DATE & ALMOND YOGHURT BOWL

-  5 AIR FRYER
-  10 ONE PAN
-  2 WOK
-  3 NO COOK

51 Sweet Potato, Egg & Chilli Hash

18
MIN



AIR FRYER

AMERICAN — 5 PREP / 13 COOK — SERVES 4

Diced sweet potato goes craggy at the edges, then you push it into four mounds and crack the eggs straight into the basket.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 700 g (1½ lb) sweet potatoes, scrubbed and cut into 1.5 cm (½ in) dice
- 1 red onion, cut into thin wedges
- 1 red pepper, cut into 2 cm (¾ in) squares
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) olive oil
- 1 tsp smoked paprika
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- ½–1 tsp chilli flakes, to taste
- ¾ tsp fine sea salt

TO FINISH

- 8 eggs
- 3 spring onions, finely sliced
- 15 g (½ cup, packed) coriander, roughly chopped
- 1 lime, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Cutting the sweet potato into 1.5 cm dice gives enough surface area to crisp in thirteen minutes, roughly half what a wedge would need. The eggs go in for the last five minutes and set on top of hot vegetables rather than bare metal, so the whites cook through while the yolks stay loose.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F).
- 2 Tip the sweet potato, onion and pepper straight into the basket. Add the oil, paprika, cumin, chilli flakes and salt, and toss with your hands until every piece is rust-coloured.
- 3 Air fry for 8 minutes, shaking hard at 4 minutes. The dice should be tender when pressed and browning at the corners.
- 4 Shake once more, then use the back of a spoon to push the hash into four rough mounds with a dip in each. Crack two eggs into each dip.
- 5 Air fry for a final 5 minutes. The whites should be opaque right up to the yolk and the yolks should still wobble; give it one more minute if you want them firm.
- 6 Scatter with spring onion and coriander and serve straight from the basket with lime wedges.

SWAP

Butternut squash or waxy new potatoes work on the same timer. For more smoke, add another ½ tsp paprika and a pinch of caraway.

BULK IT OUT

A tin of drained black beans stirred in at the shaking stage, or warm corn tortillas alongside.

MAKE IT FASTER

Dice the vegetables the night before and keep them covered in the fridge — prep drops to a minute.

LEFTOVERS

The hash keeps 3 days chilled and re-crisps in 4 minutes at 200°C (400°F). Cook the eggs fresh.

420 kcal
CALORIES

17 g
PROTEIN

40 g
CARBS

21 g
FAT

7 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one chopping board.

52 Halloumi, Tomato & Za'atar Plate

12
MIN



AIR FRYER

CYPRIOT — 4 PREP / 8 COOK — SERVES 4

Thick halloumi slices sit on a bed of cherry tomatoes; the tomatoes collapse into their own dressing while the cheese takes on a blistered gold crust.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 400 g (14 oz) halloumi, cut into 1 cm (½ in) slices
- 400 g (14 oz) cherry tomatoes, left whole
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) olive oil

TO FINISH

- 2 tbsp za'atar
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) extra virgin olive oil
- 1 lemon — half juiced, half cut into wedges
- ½ cucumber, cut into rough chunks
- 15 g (½ cup, packed) mint leaves, torn
- warm flatbread, to serve (optional)

WHY IT WORKS

Halloumi holds its shape above 200°C because the curd is heated before it is brined, so it browns rather than melting into a puddle. The za'atar is stirred through oil and spooned over at the end — the sesame and dried thyme in it would scorch and turn bitter in the basket.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F).
- 2 Pat the halloumi slices properly dry on a clean cloth — surface brine is what stops them colouring. Toss the tomatoes with the tablespoon of olive oil and spread them across the basket, then lay the halloumi on top in a single layer.
- 3 Air fry for 8 minutes. There is no need to turn the slices. They are ready when the tops are deep gold and firm and most of the tomato skins have split and slumped.
- 4 While the basket runs, stir the za'atar, extra virgin oil and lemon juice together in a small bowl with a pinch of salt.
- 5 Slide the halloumi onto a platter, tumble the tomatoes and their juices around it, and spoon the za'atar oil over everything. Add the cucumber and mint, and serve with lemon wedges and flatbread.

SWAP

Firm feta in a block behaves similarly but needs only 6 minutes. Cherry tomatoes on the vine look better and taste the same.

BULK IT OUT

A soft-boiled egg each, or a spoonful of cooked green lentils dressed with the same za'atar oil.

MAKE IT FASTER

Slice the halloumi and leave it uncovered on a plate in the fridge overnight; it dries out and browns faster.

LEFTOVERS

Halloumi turns squeaky and tough once cold. Chop it small and fry it back to life in a dry pan for a minute.

445 kcal
CALORIES

23 g
PROTEIN

8 g
CARBS

36 g
FAT

2 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one small bowl, one chopping board.

53 Masala Omelette Muffins



AIR FRYER

INDIAN

— 5 PREP / 10 COOK —

SERVES 4

15
MIN

The masala omelette poured into silicone muffin cases, so eight of them cook at once and nobody has to stand over a pan.

INGREDIENTS

- 8 eggs
- 2 tbsp thick natural yoghurt
- 1 small red onion, very finely diced
- 1 tomato, deseeded and finely diced
- 1–2 green chillies, finely chopped
- 15 g (½ cup, packed) coriander, chopped, stalks and all
- ½ tsp ground turmeric
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- ½ tsp garam masala
- ¾ tsp fine sea salt
- 1 tsp neutral oil, for greasing
- 1 lime, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

A spoonful of yoghurt whisked into the eggs adds acidity and a little fat, which keeps the set custardy instead of rubbery at air fryer temperatures. Cooking at 170°C (340°F) rather than full heat means they rise gently and hold their shape rather than doming and splitting.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 170°C (340°F). Lightly oil the silicone muffin cases or ramekins and stand them on the worktop while you mix.
- 2 Crack the eggs into a bowl, add the yoghurt and whisk for a good 20 seconds until no ribbons of white are left.
- 3 Stir in the onion, tomato, chilli, coriander, turmeric, cumin, garam masala and salt.
- 4 Fill each case about three-quarters full, then lift them into the basket in a single layer.
- 5 Air fry for 10 minutes. They are done when risen, set to the centre and a skewer comes out clean. They will sink a little as they cool, which is exactly what should happen.
- 6 Run a knife around the rims, turn them out and serve warm with lime wedges.

SWAP

A handful of chopped spinach or grated courgette folded in adds bulk without loosening the mix. Curry leaves, torn in, are worth it if you have them.

BULK IT OUT

Serve two each on buttered toast, or with a spoonful of yoghurt and mango chutney.

MAKE IT FASTER

Chop the onion, tomato and chilli the night before; the mixture itself takes 90 seconds to put together.

LEFTOVERS

Keep 3 days chilled. Eat cold from the fridge or warm for 3 minutes at 160°C (320°F).

200 kcal
CALORIES

14 g
PROTEIN

4 g
CARBS

14 g
FAT

1 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, eight silicone cases, one bowl and whisk, one chopping board.

54 Banana, Oat & Almond Butter Bake

18
MIN



AIR FRYER

BRITISH — 4 PREP / 14 COOK — SERVES 4

A shallow tin of baked oats that sets like a soft flapjack, spooned out hot under cold yoghurt.

INGREDIENTS

- 3 very ripe bananas (about 350 g / 12 oz peeled), the spottier the better
- 200 g (2 cups) rolled porridge oats
- 2 eggs
- 250 ml (1 cup) whole milk
- 3 tbsp almond butter (100% almonds)
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1½ tsp ground cinnamon
- ¼ tsp fine sea salt
- 30 g (¼ cup) flaked almonds
- a little butter, for the tin
- thick natural yoghurt, to serve

WHY IT WORKS

Very ripe bananas carry enough sugar and moisture that the bake needs no added sweetener, and mashing rather than slicing them spreads that moisture evenly through the oats. A shallow 18 cm tin gives the mixture enough surface area to set through in fourteen minutes; a deep dish would still be raw in the middle.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 175°C (350°F). Butter an 18 cm (7 in) cake tin or ovenproof dish, leaving a finger's width of clearance in the basket.
- 2 Mash the bananas in a bowl with a fork until almost smooth. Beat in the eggs, milk and 2 tbsp of the almond butter until you have a loose batter.
- 3 Stir in the oats, baking powder, cinnamon and salt. Pour into the tin and level the top.
- 4 Dot the remaining almond butter over the surface, drag a knife through it once or twice to marble it, and scatter over the flaked almonds.
- 5 Air fry for 14 minutes. It is ready when the top springs back under a finger, the edges have pulled from the tin, and a skewer in the centre comes out with no wet batter.
- 6 Spoon straight from the tin into bowls and add a spoonful of cold yoghurt to each.

SWAP

Peanut or cashew butter instead of almond. Blueberries or chopped pear pressed into the top need no extra time.

BULK IT OUT

A handful of chopped walnuts through the mix, or serve with sliced banana on the side.

MAKE IT FASTER

Mash the bananas and mix the wet ingredients the night before, then stir in the oats straight from the fridge.

LEFTOVERS

Keeps 4 days chilled and firms as it sits. Cut into squares and eat cold, or warm through for 3 minutes.

430 kcal
CALORIES

15 g
PROTEIN

57 g
CARBS

16 g
FAT

8 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one cake tin, one mixing bowl, one fork.

55 Crispy Chickpea, Avocado & Lemon Toast



AIR FRYER

MODERN LEVANTINE — 4 PREP / 8 COOK — SERVES 4

12
MIN

The chickpeas rattle around getting crisp while the bread toasts beside them in the same basket, picking up the cumin oil on the way.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASKET

- 1 × 400 g (14 oz) tin chickpeas, drained and patted very dry
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) olive oil
- 1 tsp ground cumin
- ½ tsp sweet smoked paprika
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- 4 thick slices sourdough or other good bread

TO FINISH

- 2 ripe avocados
- 1 lemon — half juiced, half cut into wedges
- 1 small garlic clove, grated
- 1 tsp sumac
- ½ tsp chilli flakes, Aleppo if you have them
- 15 g (½ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, torn

WHY IT WORKS

Chickpeas patted properly dry crisp in eight minutes at 200°C; any water left clinging to them steams the skins soft instead. The bread joins them for the final three minutes and comes out dry-edged and rigid, which is what lets it hold a thick layer of mashed avocado without collapsing.

METHOD

- 1 Heat the air fryer to 200°C (400°F). Tip the dry chickpeas into the basket, add the oil, cumin, paprika and salt, and toss until evenly coated.
- 2 Air fry for 5 minutes, shaking hard at the halfway point.
- 3 Shake again, push the chickpeas to one side and lay the bread slices flat on top of them. Air fry for a further 3 minutes: the chickpeas should crack rather than squash when pressed, and the bread should be toasted and dry at the edges.
- 4 Meanwhile, halve the avocados, scoop the flesh into a bowl and mash roughly with the lemon juice, grated garlic and a good pinch of salt. Leave it lumpy.
- 5 Spread the avocado thickly over the toast, spoon the hot chickpeas on top, and scatter with sumac, chilli flakes and parsley. Serve with lemon wedges.

SWAP

Butter beans crisp in the same window and go creamier inside. Tahini loosened with lemon and water instead of avocado.

BULK IT OUT

A soft-boiled egg halved over each slice, or a second tin of chickpeas in the basket.

MAKE IT FASTER

Drain and dry the chickpeas the night before and leave them uncovered in the fridge; they crisp a minute quicker.

LEFTOVERS

The chickpeas keep 3 days in an open jar at room temperature and stay crisp. Mashed avocado does not keep; make only what you need.

500 kcal
CALORIES

14 g
PROTEIN

52 g
CARBS

25 g
FAT

14 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP Air fryer basket, one bowl, one chopping board.

56 Tamagoyaki with Rice & Nori



ONE PAN

JAPANESE

— 4 PREP / 8 COOK —

SERVES 4

12
MIN

A rolled Japanese omelette built in thin layers in one pan, cut thick and laid over warm rice.

INGREDIENTS

- 8 eggs
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) mirin (or 2 tsp honey stirred with 1 tsp water)
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) light soy sauce or tamari, plus more to serve
- ¼ tsp fine sea salt
- 2 tsp neutral oil, for the pan
- 600 g (about 4 cups) cooked short-grain rice, warm
- 2 sheets nori, snipped into strips
- 2 spring onions, finely sliced
- 1 tbsp toasted sesame seeds

WHY IT WORKS

Cooking the egg in three thin pours rather than one thick one lets each layer set in seconds and roll while still tacky, which is what glues the spiral together. The mirin brings just enough sugar for the outside to take colour before the inside dries.

METHOD

- 1 Beat the eggs with the mirin, soy and salt for a full 30 seconds, until no ribbons of white remain.
- 2 Wipe a 20–24 cm (8–10 in) non-stick frying pan with an oiled scrap of kitchen paper and set it over medium heat. Keep the paper to hand.
- 3 Pour in a third of the egg and tilt to cover the base. When the top is barely set but still glossy, 30 to 40 seconds, roll it towards you with a spatula.
- 4 Push the roll to the far edge, oil the pan again and pour in another third, lifting the roll so raw egg runs underneath. Let it set, then roll it around the first. Repeat with the last third.
- 5 Slide the roll out, press it into a neat log and cut into 2 cm (¾ in) slices. The centre should be just set and a shade paler than the outside.
- 6 Divide the warm rice between four bowls, lay the slices on top and scatter with nori, spring onion and sesame. Pass more soy at the table.

SWAP

Grated carrot or chopped chives beaten into the eggs. Dashi in place of the water if you go the honey route.

BULK IT OUT

Sliced avocado, quick-pickled cucumber, or a spoonful of kimchi on the side.

MAKE IT FASTER

A square tamagoyaki pan makes a tidier roll, but a round one works and saves owning another pan.

LEFTOVERS

Good cold in a lunchbox for 2 days; slice it thicker so it stays juicy.

370 kcal
CALORIES

17 g
PROTEIN

45 g
CARBS

13 g
FAT

2 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one bowl, one chopping board.

57 Gyeran Bap — Korean Egg Rice

🍳 ONE PAN

KOREAN — 3 PREP / 7 COOK — SERVES 4

10
MIN

Rice loosened in a hot pan, eggs fried hard in sesame oil until the edges frill and brown, all mixed together at the table.

INGREDIENTS

- 600 g (about 4 cups) cooked short-grain rice, cold from the fridge
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) water
- 8 eggs
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) toasted sesame oil, plus a few drops to finish
- 20 g (1½ tbsp) butter
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) light soy sauce or tamari
- 4 sheets gim (roasted seaweed), crumbled, or 2 sheets nori, snipped
- 3 spring onions, finely sliced
- 1 tsp gochugaru (Korean chilli flakes)
- 1 tbsp toasted sesame seeds

WHY IT WORKS

A splash of water in the pan steams cold rice apart in two minutes, so yesterday's grains behave like freshly cooked. Frying the eggs in the same pan over high heat crisps the whites while the yolks stay liquid, and those yolks are the only sauce it needs.

METHOD

- 1 Put the rice and water into a large non-stick frying pan over medium heat. Break the clumps up with a spoon and stir for 2 minutes, until the grains are steaming and separate.
- 2 Divide between four bowls. Add a piece of butter and a splash of soy to each while the rice is hot, and stir until melted.
- 3 Return the pan to high heat and add 1 tbsp of the sesame oil. Crack in four eggs and fry for 2 minutes without moving them. The edges should blister, frill and brown while the white nearest the yolk turns opaque.
- 4 Slide two eggs onto each of two bowls, then repeat with the remaining oil and eggs.
- 5 Top each bowl with gim, spring onion, gochugaru and sesame seeds, add the last of the soy and a few drops of sesame oil, and take them to the table. Break the yolks and mix hard before the first mouthful.

SWAP

Brown rice works and takes a minute longer to loosen. Gochujang stirred through instead of the dried chilli flakes.

BULK IT OUT

A handful of spinach wilted into the rice, or kimchi and cucumber on the side.

MAKE IT FASTER

Cook double the rice whenever you make it and keep it chilled — this becomes a five-minute breakfast.

LEFTOVERS

None worth keeping; a fried egg on rice does not survive the fridge. Cook only what you will eat.

455 kcal
CALORIES

17 g
PROTEIN

45 g
CARBS

23 g
FAT

2 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One frying pan, one chopping board; the bowls you eat from.

58 Ten-Minute Ginger Congee



ONE PAN

CHINESE — 4 PREP / 11 COOK — SERVES 4

Cold rice from last night, pulsed until the grains fracture, then boiled hard until it turns silky.

INGREDIENTS

- 500 g (3 cups) cold cooked rice, ideally short-grain or jasmine
- 1.2 litres (5 cups) water or unsalted chicken stock
- 30 g (1 oz) fresh ginger — half in coins, half finely shredded
- 1 tsp fine sea salt, plus more to taste
- 4 eggs
- 4 spring onions, sliced, whites and greens kept apart
- ½ tsp ground white pepper
- 2 tsp toasted sesame oil
- 40 g (¼ cup) roasted peanuts, crushed
- A small handful of coriander leaves

WHY IT WORKS

Congee usually takes an hour because whole grains have to burst open from the inside. Pulsing cold cooked rice breaks them before they reach the pan, and a hard rolling boil rather than a gentle simmer keeps the released starch moving, so it thickens in ten minutes.

METHOD

- 1 Put the cold rice in a blender jug with 300 ml (1¼ cups) of the water. Pulse four or five times, one second each: you want fractured grains and cloudy liquid, not a purée.
- 2 Tip it into a wide pan with the rest of the liquid, the ginger coins, the spring onion whites and the salt. Bring to a hard, rolling boil.
- 3 Boil 10 minutes, stirring every couple of minutes and scraping the base so nothing catches. It is ready when a spoon dragged across the bottom leaves a trail that closes slowly behind it.
- 4 Drop the heat, crack in the eggs and stir once so the whites ribbon through. Sixty seconds sets them.
- 5 Season with white pepper and more salt than you expect. Ladle into bowls and top with shredded ginger, spring onion greens, sesame oil, peanuts and coriander.

SWAP

No blender? Crush the cold rice against the side of the pan with a wooden spoon for a minute instead. Cooked pearl barley behaves the same way.

BULK IT OUT

Wilt in two handfuls of spinach at the end, or poach prawns for the last 3 minutes.

MAKE IT FASTER

Pulse the rice the night before and keep it in the fridge in its water.

LEFTOVERS

Sets solid when chilled. Loosen with boiling water a ladleful at a time and boil for 2 minutes.

345 kcal
CALORIES

12 g
PROTEIN

37 g
CARBS

17 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One pan, one blender jug, one chopping board.

59 Rava Uttapam with Coconut Chutney

18
MIN



ONE PAN

INDIAN (SOUTH) — 8 PREP / 10 COOK — SERVES 4

A thick, freckled semolina pancake with onion and tomato pressed into the top, and no fermenting involved.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE CHUTNEY

- 80 g (1 cup) desiccated or fresh grated coconut
- 30 g (¼ cup) cashews or roasted chana dal
- 2 cm (¾ in) fresh ginger and 1 green chilli
- 120 ml (½ cup) cold water, ½ tsp salt, juice of ½ lemon
- 1 tsp coconut oil, 1 tsp black mustard seeds, 8 curry leaves

FOR THE UTTAPAM

- 200 g (1¼ cups) fine semolina (rava)
- 150 g (⅔ cup) plain yoghurt
- 200 ml (¾ cup) water and ½ tsp fine sea salt
- 1 red onion, finely chopped
- 1 tomato, deseeded, and 1 green chilli, both finely chopped
- 15 g (½ cup, loose) coriander, chopped
- ½ tsp bicarbonate of soda
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) coconut or sunflower oil

WHY IT WORKS

Fine semolina swells in yoghurt within minutes, so a short stand does what an overnight rice-and-dal ferment would, and the yoghurt supplies the sourness. The bicarbonate goes in last, meeting that acid in the hot pan rather than in the bowl.

METHOD

- 1 Whisk the semolina, yoghurt, water and salt in a bowl until smooth, then leave it to swell while you do everything else.
- 2 Blitz everything for the chutney except the oil, mustard seeds and curry leaves for 40 seconds, until thick and spoonable. Scrape into a dish.
- 3 Heat the pan with the coconut oil, mustard seeds and curry leaves until the seeds pop, 30 seconds. Pour over the chutney and wipe the pan out.
- 4 Stir in the bicarbonate; the batter should mound on a spoon, so loosen with water if it has stiffened. Oil the pan and ladle in two rounds, 1 cm thick.
- 5 Scatter over onion, tomato, chilli and coriander, pressing them in with the ladle. Cook 3 minutes, until the base is freckled brown and the top dull, then flip for 2 minutes more.
- 6 Repeat with the rest and serve hot, chutney alongside.

SWAP

Grated carrot or courgette instead of tomato adds no water.

BULK IT OUT

Stir cooked chana dal through the batter, or add soft-boiled eggs.

MAKE IT FASTER

Make the chutney the night before; it keeps 3 days chilled.

LEFTOVERS

Reheat dry in the pan, a minute a side, never in the microwave.

455 kcal
CALORIES

11 g
PROTEIN

50 g
CARBS

24 g
FAT

7 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One pan, one bowl, one blender jug, one chopping board.

60 Persian Herb & Feta Omelette

🍳 ONE PAN

IRANIAN — 6 PREP / 9 COOK — SERVES 4

15
MIN

More herb than egg, in the manner of a kuku, cooked flat in one pan and cut into wedges at the table.

INGREDIENTS

- 8 eggs
- 40 g (1½ cups, packed) flat-leaf parsley, finely chopped
- 30 g (1 cup, packed) coriander, finely chopped
- 20 g (¾ cup, packed) dill, finely chopped
- 20 g (½ cup) chives or spring onion tops, finely sliced
- ½ tsp ground turmeric and ¼ tsp ground cinnamon
- ½ tsp fine sea salt and plenty of black pepper
- 50 g (½ cup) walnuts, roughly chopped
- 2 tbsp dried barberries, or chopped dried sour cherries
- 150 g (5 oz) feta, crumbled
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) olive oil
- 1 lemon, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

A kuku is close to half herbs by volume, and chopping them properly fine is what lets them collapse into the eggs instead of sitting there as damp green ribbons. Cooking gently under a lid sets the top with trapped steam, so there is no grilling, no flipping and no browned underside.

METHOD

- 1 Chop the herbs on a board, tender stalks and all, until they fall in a soft heap rather than in strands.
- 2 Beat the eggs in a bowl with the turmeric, cinnamon, salt and pepper, then fold in the herbs, walnuts, barberries and two thirds of the feta. It should look overwhelmingly green.
- 3 Warm the oil in a 24 cm (10 in) pan over medium-low heat, pour in the mixture and spread it level. Scatter the last of the feta over the top.
- 4 Cover and cook for 9 minutes without touching it. It is done when the centre no longer wobbles as you shake the pan and the edges have pulled inwards. The base should be set and pale gold, not dark.
- 5 Slide onto the board, rest a minute, cut into wedges and serve with lemon to squeeze over.

SWAP

Fenugreek leaves in place of some of the parsley take it closer to a Nowruz kuku. Any soft white cheese stands in for feta.

BULK IT OUT

Warm flatbread in the pan afterwards and put thick yoghurt and sliced radish on the table.

MAKE IT FASTER

Chop the herbs the night before and box them with a sheet of kitchen paper.

LEFTOVERS

Better cold than hot. Keeps 3 days chilled and travels well in a lunchbox.

400 kcal
CALORIES

21 g
PROTEIN

5 g
CARBS

33 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One pan with its lid, one bowl, one chopping board.

61 Huevos Rancheros Rápidos

15
MIN

🍳 ONE PAN

MEXICAN — 5 PREP / 10 COOK — SERVES 4

Tinned tomatoes fried hard with dried chilli, black beans stirred through, and eight eggs sunk into the lot under a lid.

INGREDIENTS

- 8 small corn tortillas
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) olive or sunflower oil
- 1 onion, finely chopped
- 3 garlic cloves, sliced
- 1 dried chipotle or 2 dried anchos, stalks removed, torn up
- 2 tsp ground cumin
- 400 g (14 oz) tin chopped tomatoes
- 400 g (14 oz) tin black beans, drained and rinsed
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- 8 eggs
- 1 ripe avocado, sliced
- 80 g (3 oz) feta, crumbled
- 1 lime in wedges, and a handful of coriander

WHY IT WORKS

Frying the tomatoes over high heat until they darken and stop smelling raw is what separates a ranchero sauce from warmed passata, and it takes four minutes. The eggs then poach in the sauce itself, so the yolks stay loose while the whites set against the hot base of the pan.

METHOD

- 1 Warm the dry pan over medium-high heat and toast the tortillas for 20 seconds a side, until they smell nutty and flex without cracking. Stack them on the board under a cloth.
- 2 Add the oil, onion, garlic, torn chilli and cumin to the same pan and fry 3 minutes, until the onion turns translucent and the chilli smells sweet.
- 3 Tip in the tomatoes and raise the heat. Fry hard for 4 minutes, stirring, until the sauce darkens to brick red and a spoon dragged through leaves a clear channel. Stir in the beans and salt.
- 4 Make eight shallow wells with the back of the spoon and crack an egg into each. Cover and cook 4 minutes, until the whites are opaque and the yolks still shiver when you nudge the pan.
- 5 Scatter over avocado, feta and coriander, and take the pan to the table with the tortillas and lime.

SWAP

Pinto or kidney beans behave the same. No dried chilli means 2 tsp smoked paprika and a pinch of cayenne.

BULK IT OUT

Wilt a bag of spinach into the sauce before the eggs, or add plain rice.

MAKE IT FASTER

Build the sauce to the end of step 3 the night before; it takes the eggs in 5 minutes from cold.

LEFTOVERS

The sauce keeps 3 days; the eggs do not, so poach only what you will eat.

495 kcal
CALORIES

23 g
PROTEIN

45 g
CARBS

25 g
FAT

12 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One pan with its lid, one chopping board.

62 Pan con Tomate with Soft Eggs

10
MIN



ONE PAN

SPANISH — 3 PREP / 7 COOK — SERVES 4

Bread fried in olive oil until it crackles, cold grated tomato spooned over, and an egg from the same pan with the yolk still loose.

INGREDIENTS

- 4 thick slices sourdough or country loaf, about 60 g (2 oz) each
- 4 tbsp (60 ml) extra virgin olive oil
- 4 very ripe tomatoes, halved across the middle
- 1 fat garlic clove, halved
- ½ tsp flaky sea salt
- 8 eggs
- Black pepper

WHY IT WORKS

Grating a halved tomato on the coarse holes of a box grater leaves the skin flat in your hand and gives you seasoned pulp with no chopping and nothing to drain. Frying the bread in oil rather than toasting it dry builds a crust that holds up under the wet tomato for as long as it takes to eat.

METHOD

- 1 Grate the cut faces of the tomatoes into a bowl on the coarse holes of a box grater until only the flat skins are left in your hand. Stir in the salt and set aside.
- 2 Heat 3 tbsp of the oil in a wide pan over medium-high heat and fry the bread for 2 minutes a side, pressing it into the oil, until it is deep gold and sounds hard when tapped. Rub each hot slice with the cut garlic and put it on the board.
- 3 Add the last tablespoon of oil, drop the heat to medium and crack in the eggs. Fry for 3 minutes, tilting the pan and spooning hot oil over the tops, until the whites are set and lacy at the edges and the yolks still wobble.
- 4 Spoon the tomato thickly over each slice and let it soak in for a moment. Slide two eggs onto each, then finish with black pepper and any oil left in the pan.

SWAP

Out of season, use 250 g (9 oz) tinned whole tomatoes crushed by hand and drained for a minute.

BULK IT OUT

Add a few slices of manchego under the tomato, or serve with a plate of sliced cucumber and olives.

MAKE IT FASTER

Grate the tomatoes while the pan heats and the whole thing lands in eight minutes.

LEFTOVERS

The tomato keeps overnight and is better for it; the bread must be fried to order.

425 kcal
CALORIES

18 g
PROTEIN

34 g
CARBS

24 g
FAT

4 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One pan, one bowl, one grater, one chopping board.

63 Ful Medames

12
MIN



ONE PAN

EGYPTIAN — 4 PREP / 8 COOK — SERVES 4

Fava beans crushed against the side of the pan with cumin and lemon, eggs cracked into the middle, eaten with your hands.

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tsp cumin seeds
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) extra virgin olive oil, plus more to finish
- 3 garlic cloves, crushed
- 2 × 400 g (14 oz) tins ful medames or brown fava beans, drained
- 150 ml ($\frac{2}{3}$ cup) water
- $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp fine sea salt and $\frac{1}{4}$ tsp chilli flakes
- Juice of 1 lemon
- 2 tbsp tahini
- 4 eggs
- 2 tomatoes, chopped small
- $\frac{1}{2}$ small red onion, finely chopped
- 20 g ($\frac{1}{2}$ cup, packed) flat-leaf parsley, chopped

WHY IT WORKS

Crushing only half the beans gives you a thick base that holds the olive oil and whole beans that still have bite, which is the whole texture of ful. Cumin seeds toasted dry for thirty seconds before anything else goes in taste nothing like ground cumin stirred into hot liquid at the end.

METHOD

- 1 Toast the cumin seeds in the dry pan over medium heat for 30 seconds, until they smell warm and darken a shade. Tip onto the board and crush roughly under the flat of a knife.
- 2 Return them to the pan with the oil and garlic and fry for 30 seconds only — the garlic should stay pale and smell sweet, not toasted.
- 3 Add the beans, water, salt and chilli. Simmer for 4 minutes, crushing about half of them against the side of the pan with a wooden spoon, until it is stew-thick and the whole beans still hold their shape.
- 4 Stir through the lemon juice and tahini. Make four wells, crack in the eggs, cover and cook 3 minutes, until the whites are set and the yolks runny.
- 5 Scatter over the tomato, onion and parsley, pour a thread of olive oil across the top and take the pan to the table.

SWAP

Tinned brown lentils or borlotti beans crush the same way if fava beans are hard to find.

BULK IT OUT

Warm flatbread for scooping, and add sliced cucumber and radish alongside.

MAKE IT FASTER

Use ready-ground cumin and toast it in the oil for 10 seconds instead of step 1.

LEFTOVERS

The beans keep 3 days and thicken; loosen with water and a squeeze of lemon over low heat.

370 kcal
CALORIES

18 g
PROTEIN

25 g
CARBS

22 g
FAT

11 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One pan with its lid, one chopping board.

64 Buckwheat Galette with Egg & Greens

18
MIN

🍳 ONE PAN

FRENCH (BRETON) — 4 PREP / 14 COOK — SERVES 4

A lacy buckwheat pancake with the egg cracked straight onto it and the four sides folded in to frame the yolk.

INGREDIENTS

- 120 g (1 cup) buckwheat flour
- 300 ml (1¼ cups) cold water
- 5 eggs — one for the batter, four for the tops
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- 30 g (2 tbsp) butter
- 150 g (5 oz) baby spinach or young chard, shredded
- 100 g (1 cup) Gruyère or mature Cheddar, coarsely grated
- Black pepper and a scrape of nutmeg

WHY IT WORKS

Buckwheat has no gluten to relax, so a batter thin enough to pour like single cream needs no resting at all — the flour hydrates in the two minutes the pan takes to heat. Cracking the egg onto the cooked side lets it set in the galette's own heat while the underside crisps, so nothing has to be turned twice.

METHOD

- 1 Whisk the flour, water, one egg and the salt in a bowl until smooth. It should coat the whisk and run straight off, as thin as single cream; add a splash more water if it clings. Thin batter needs no resting.
- 2 Melt a knob of the butter in a 24 cm (10 in) pan over medium-high heat. Pour in a quarter of the batter and swirl at once to the edges. Cook 90 seconds, until the surface dulls and the edge lifts cleanly.
- 3 Flip it, scatter over a quarter of the spinach and cheese, and crack an egg into the middle. Season with pepper and nutmeg.
- 4 Fold the four sides in to make a square frame around the yolk. Cover and cook 2 minutes, until the white is opaque, the yolk still moves and the base is crisp underneath.
- 5 Slide onto a plate and repeat with the rest, buttering the pan each time. Eat as they come, rather than holding them warm.

SWAP

Half buckwheat and half plain flour makes a softer, less earthy galette that folds more easily.

BULK IT OUT

Add a slice of ham or a spoon of soft goat's cheese under the egg.

MAKE IT FASTER

Whisk the batter the night before; it keeps three days and only needs a stir.

LEFTOVERS

Cook plain galettes with what is left of the batter, stack between baking paper and reheat in the dry pan.

360 kcal
CALORIES

20 g
PROTEIN

23 g
CARBS

21 g
FAT

4 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One pan with its lid, one bowl, one grater.

65 Khao Tom — Thai Rice Soup with Prawns



ONE PAN

THAI

5 PREP / 10 COOK

— SERVES 4

15
MIN

Last night's rice loosens into a gingery broth, and the prawns cook in the stored heat alone.

INGREDIENTS

- 600 g (4 cups) cold cooked jasmine rice, leftover from last night
- 1.2 litres (5 cups) light chicken or vegetable stock
- 400 g (14 oz) raw peeled prawns
- 30 g (1 oz) fresh ginger, cut into fine matchsticks
- 4 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 2 tsp (10 ml) groundnut or sunflower oil
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) fish sauce
- 1 tsp ground white pepper
- 1 head pak choi (~150 g / 5 oz), shredded
- 4 spring onions, finely sliced
- 20 g (½ cup, packed) coriander, leaves and stalks
- 2 limes, cut into wedges

WHY IT WORKS

Cooked rice has already gelatinised, so it only needs to swell and warm through: five minutes in stock gives a soup with real body where raw-rice congee wants an hour. The prawns go in off the heat, where the warmth held in the broth cooks them through without tightening them.

METHOD

- 1 Warm the oil in a large saucepan over a medium heat. Add the garlic and ginger and stir for 1 minute, until the garlic is pale gold and smells sweet — any darker and it turns bitter.
- 2 Pour in the stock, raise the heat and bring to a fast boil.
- 3 Break the cold rice apart with your fingers as you drop it in so no clumps survive. Simmer 5 minutes, until the grains plump and the broth coats the back of a spoon.
- 4 Stir in the pak choi, fish sauce and white pepper. Slide in the prawns, lift the pan off the heat and put the lid on. Leave 2 minutes — they are ready when opaque right through and curled into a loose C.
- 5 Ladle into deep bowls, scatter with spring onion and coriander, and squeeze lime over at the table.

SWAP

Flaked salmon, shredded chicken or firm tofu all sit in this broth as happily as prawns. Cold brown rice wants 8 minutes rather than 5.

BULK IT OUT

Beat an egg and stir it through the boiling soup in step 3 for ribbons.

MAKE IT FASTER

Leave the ginger unpeeled and slice it thin — the skin softens away in the broth.

LEFTOVERS

The rice drinks the broth overnight, so loosen with water when you reheat.

310 kcal
CALORIES

25 g
PROTEIN

44 g
CARBS

4 g
FAT

2 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One saucepan, one chopping board, one knife.

66 Egg & Tomato Stir-Fry

WOK

CHINESE — 4 PREP / 6 COOK — SERVES 4

10
MIN

Soft-scrambled eggs folded back into collapsed tomatoes, over cold rice fried underneath to catch the juices.

INGREDIENTS

- 8 large eggs
- 600 g (4 cups) cold cooked rice, leftover from last night
- 600 g (1 lb 5 oz) ripe tomatoes, cut into eighths
- 3 tbsp (45 ml) groundnut or sunflower oil
- 1 tbsp finely grated fresh ginger
- 3 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 1 tsp honey
- 1 tbsp (15 ml) light soy sauce
- 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- ¼ tsp ground white pepper
- 4 spring onions, cut into 3 cm (1 in) lengths

WHY IT WORKS

Cooking the eggs first and lifting them out while glossy keeps them tender; they finish in the pan's warmth rather than seizing alongside the tomatoes. Tomatoes cooked hard and fast throw out enough juice to season the rice, and cold rice, dried out overnight, drinks it instead of turning to paste.

METHOD

- 1 Beat the eggs with the salt and white pepper until no streaks of white remain. Break the cold rice up with your fingers so the grains are separate.
- 2 Heat 2 tbsp of the oil in a wok over a high heat until it shimmers. Pour in the eggs, count to ten, then push them from the edges to the centre. Tip them onto a plate while still wet and glossy, about 45 seconds.
- 3 Add the last tablespoon of oil, then the ginger and garlic. Stir 20 seconds, add the tomatoes and cook hard for 3 minutes, pressing with the spoon until the skins slip and a loose red sauce gathers.
- 4 Tip in the rice and toss for 2 minutes, until every grain is coated and the wok sounds dry again. Stir through the honey and soy.
- 5 Return the eggs, breaking them into large curds, add the spring onions and sesame oil, and fold twice. Serve straight from the wok.

SWAP

Tinned plum tomatoes carry this out of season; drain them well or the rice goes soggy.

BULK IT OUT

A handful of frozen peas or shredded spinach goes in with the rice.

MAKE IT FASTER

Beat the eggs in the bowl you will serve from, and tip them onto the board in step 2.

LEFTOVERS

Good cold next day. Reheat in a hot dry pan, never the microwave, or the eggs weep.

430 kcal
CALORIES

18 g
PROTEIN

45 g
CARBS

19 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One wok, one mixing bowl, one chopping board.

67 Sinangag — Filipino Garlic Rice & Egg



WOK

FILIPINO — 4 PREP / 8 COOK — SERVES 4

12
MIN

A whole head of garlic in last night's rice, half fried to crisp gold and saved for the top.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE RICE

- 700 g (4½ cups) cold cooked rice, leftover from last night
- 1 head garlic (~12 cloves), thinly sliced
- 4 tbsp (60 ml) sunflower or coconut oil
- ½ tsp fine sea salt
- ¼ tsp coarsely ground black pepper

TO SERVE

- 4 large eggs
- 2 large ripe tomatoes, cut into wedges
- ½ cucumber, sliced on the angle
- 4 spring onions, finely sliced
- 2 limes or calamansi, halved

WHY IT WORKS

Starting the garlic in cold oil draws out its sugars before the edges colour, so it turns nutty and crisp rather than scorched. Cold rice has lost enough surface moisture overnight to fry into separate toasted grains; warm rice from the pot steams and clumps.

METHOD

- 1 Break the cold rice apart with your fingers until no lumps remain. Lay the tomato and cucumber out on the plates.
- 2 Put the garlic and 3 tbsp of the oil in a cold wok, then set it over a medium heat. Fry, stirring, 3 to 4 minutes until the slices are pale gold and the bubbling slows. Lift half onto kitchen paper at once, since they keep darkening off the heat.
- 3 Turn the heat to high. Add the rice, salt and pepper to the garlic and oil left in the wok, press flat and leave 45 seconds, then toss. Repeat for 3 minutes, until the grains separate, smell toasted and carry crisp brown patches.
- 4 Divide the rice between the plates and wipe out the wok. Add the last tablespoon of oil and crack in the eggs. Fry 2 minutes, spooning hot oil over the whites, until the edges are lacy and the yolks still run.
- 5 Sit an egg on each mound, scatter over the reserved crisp garlic and spring onions, and serve with lime to squeeze.

SWAP

Day-old brown or red rice fries just as well; give it an extra minute to loosen.

BULK IT OUT

Flake in a tin of sardines or some smoked mackerel with the rice at step 3.

MAKE IT FASTER

Slice the garlic the night before and keep it submerged in oil in a jar.

LEFTOVERS

Cold garlic rice fries again happily. Store the crisp garlic in a dry jar or it goes soft.

430 kcal
CALORIES

11 g
PROTEIN

52 g
CARBS

20 g
FAT

3 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One wok, one chopping board, one knife.

68 Ten-Minute Bircher Muesli



🔪 NO COOK

SWISS — 10 PREP / 0 COOK — SERVES 4

The overnight soak is only a hydration problem, and warm milk with a grated apple solves it while you chop the nuts.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASE

- 200 g (2 cups) rolled porridge oats, not jumbo
- 400 ml (1½ cups) whole milk
- 200 g (¾ cup) thick natural yoghurt
- 2 crisp eating apples, unpeeled
- 1 lemon, juice only
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) runny honey
- ½ tsp ground cinnamon
- Pinch of fine sea salt

TO FINISH

- 60 g (½ cup) hazelnuts or almonds, roughly chopped
- 200 g (1½ cups) raspberries or blueberries

WHY IT WORKS

Oats take up liquid far faster when it is warm, so milk at body temperature does in six minutes what a night in the fridge does slowly. Grating the apple on the coarse side of the box grater releases its juice straight into the bowl, which softens the flakes further and takes the raw edge off them.

METHOD

- 1 Warm the milk until it feels blood-warm on the inside of your wrist: 60 seconds in a jug in the microwave, or a little just-boiled water topped up with cold milk. Never hot.
- 2 Tip the oats, cinnamon and salt into a large bowl, pour on the warm milk and stir once. Leave it to sit while you do the next step.
- 3 Grate both apples, skin and all, on the coarse side of a box grater straight into the bowl, turning the core as you go. Squeeze over the lemon and stir it through so the apple stays pale.
- 4 Stir in the yoghurt and honey. The mixture should slump off the spoon rather than hold its shape; loosen with a splash more milk if it does. The oats have had six minutes by now and should be soft with the barest bite at the centre.
- 5 Spoon into four bowls and scatter with the nuts and berries.

SWAP

Warmed cloudy apple juice in place of milk makes a sharper dairy-free version; use coconut yoghurt with it.

BULK IT OUT

A grated pear, a spoonful of ground almonds or a handful of raisins, stirred in at step 4.

MAKE IT FASTER

Pulse jumbo oats three or four times in a blender. Smaller flakes hydrate in half the time.

LEFTOVERS

Keeps three days chilled and genuinely improves. Hold the nuts back until serving so they stay crisp.

430 kcal
CALORIES

17 g
PROTEIN

59 g
CARBS

14 g
FAT

8 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One large bowl, one box grater, one jug.

69 Danish Rye with Cottage Cheese, Cucumber & Dill

8
MIN

🍴 NO COOK

DANISH — 8 PREP / 0 COOK — SERVES 4

Dense dark rye, cold cottage cheese and enough dill to smell green from across the kitchen.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BASE

- 8 slices dense dark rye bread (rugbrød), about 90 g (3 oz) per person
- 400 g (1¾ cups) cottage cheese
- 2 tbsp (30 ml) extra-virgin olive oil

FOR THE TOP

- 1 cucumber
- 8 radishes, sliced into thin coins
- 20 g (¾ cup, loosely packed) dill, fronds picked
- 1 lemon, zest and juice
- 20 g (2 tbsp) pumpkin seeds
- ½ tsp flaky sea salt
- Coarsely ground black pepper

WHY IT WORKS

Salting the cucumber ribbons and leaving them while you build the rest draws out the water that would otherwise run straight into the bread. Rye this dense needs no toasting; the oil and the fat in the cottage cheese are what carry it, and a hard grind of black pepper does the rest.

METHOD

- 1 Run a peeler down the length of the cucumber to make long ribbons, stopping when you reach the seedy core. Pile them on the board, toss with the flaky salt and leave for 5 minutes.
- 2 Lay the rye out, two slices per plate. Spoon the cottage cheese on in rough heaps rather than spreading it flat, so there are ridges for the oil to sit in.
- 3 Squeeze the cucumber ribbons gently over the sink. A surprising amount of water comes out and they should feel limp and glassy. Toss them with the lemon juice.
- 4 Drape the ribbons over the cottage cheese, tuck the radish coins in among them, and scatter with dill, pumpkin seeds and lemon zest.
- 5 Trickle over the olive oil, add a hard grind of black pepper, and eat with a knife and fork while the cucumber is still cold.

SWAP

Thick natural yoghurt or ricotta in place of the cottage cheese. Sourdough stands in for the rye, though you lose the sour depth.

BULK IT OUT

Half a sliced avocado per plate, or a third slice of rye for anyone walking to work.

MAKE IT FASTER

Cut the cucumber into coins rather than ribbons and skip the salting entirely.

LEFTOVERS

Assembled, it softens within the hour. The dressed cucumber and dill keep two days in a covered bowl.

390 kcal
CALORIES

21 g
PROTEIN

44 g
CARBS

14 g
FAT

8 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One chopping board, one peeler, four plates.

70 Orange, Date & Almond Yoghurt Bowl



🍴 NO COOK

MOROCCAN — 8 PREP / 0 COOK — SERVES 4

Oranges cut into rounds on the board so every drop of juice ends up on the yoghurt, with dates and almonds for chew.

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE BOWLS

- 600 g (2½ cups) thick Greek or strained natural yoghurt
- 4 large oranges
- 8 Medjool dates, stoned and torn into strips
- 60 g (½ cup) almonds, roughly chopped

TO FINISH

- 1 tbsp (15 ml) runny honey
- ½ tsp ground cinnamon
- ½ tsp orange blossom water
- 12 mint leaves, torn
- Pinch of flaky sea salt

WHY IT WORKS

Cutting the peel and pith away with a knife and slicing the oranges across into rounds holds far more juice in the fruit than segmenting does, and whatever escapes onto the board goes over the top as a dressing. Cinnamon and orange blossom water both read as sweetness on their own, so one spoon of honey is enough for four bowls.

METHOD

- 1 Stir the orange blossom water and half the cinnamon through the yoghurt. Divide it between four shallow bowls and spread it to the edges with the back of a spoon.
- 2 Sit an orange on the board and cut the top and bottom flat. Cut down the sides, following the curve of the fruit, until no white pith is left, then slice it across into rounds about 1 cm (½ in) thick. Repeat with the rest and keep the juice on the board.
- 3 Lay the rounds over the yoghurt in overlapping circles, then tip the juice from the board over them.
- 4 Scatter with the dates, almonds and mint. Trickle over the honey, dust with the rest of the cinnamon and add the smallest pinch of salt, which sharpens the fruit.
- 5 Serve straight away, while the yoghurt is still cold against the room-temperature oranges.

SWAP

Blood oranges in late winter, or ripe peaches in high summer, cut the same way. Pistachios in place of almonds.

BULK IT OUT

Stir a spoonful of rolled oats through the yoghurt at step 1; they soften while you slice the oranges.

MAKE IT FASTER

Chop the dates and almonds first and leave them on the board, then use the same board for the oranges.

LEFTOVERS

Fruit and yoghurt keep three days apart. Assembled, the juice thins the yoghurt overnight.

465 kcal
CALORIES

19 g
PROTEIN

65 g
CARBS

15 g
FAT

9 g
FIBRE

WASHING UP One chopping board, one knife, four bowls.

A Few Things Worth Knowing

None of these are recipes. They are the six things that make the seventy recipes work, and they will make everything else you cook better too.

SALT

Season the pan, not the plate. A dish salted at the end tastes of salt; a dish salted as it cooks tastes of itself. The exception is anything raw or dressed, which wants it at the last moment or it weeps.

HEAT

Almost every fast recipe that disappoints was cooked in a pan that was not hot enough. Food that steams instead of browning has lost the only advantage speed gives you.

RESTING

Even four minutes off the heat will do more for a chicken thigh than any amount of extra cooking. Use the time to wash the pan.

FAT

Do not be frightened of the tablespoon of oil. It carries flavour, it conducts heat, and a dish cooked in too little of it browns unevenly and tastes thin.

GARLIC

Grated garlic burns in ninety seconds. Sliced garlic takes three minutes. Choose the cut to suit the time the dish has, rather than the other way round.

ACID

If something tastes flat and you have already salted it, it wants acid, not more salt. Lemon, lime, vinegar, a spoonful of yoghurt. This is the single most useful thing in this book.

CROWDING

Two batches in a hot pan beat one batch in a full one, every time. In the air fryer, a single layer with gaps is not a suggestion.

STORING

Cooked grains, roasted vegetables and cooked pulses keep three days and turn nearly any recipe here into a five-minute one. Dressed leaves and raw marinated fish keep for none.

HERBS

Soft herbs — coriander, basil, mint, parsley — go in off the heat or they turn to hay. Hard herbs like thyme and oregano go in early or they taste raw.

TASTING

Taste at the second-to-last minute, not after plating. Once it is on the plate the only thing you can still add is lemon.

The best cooking you will do this year will almost certainly take under twenty minutes, be eaten standing at the counter, and never be photographed. That is rather the point.

THE BOOK

Seventy recipes across 45 cuisines. Fifty for lunch and dinner, twenty for breakfast. Twenty air fryer, thirty-five one pan, seven wok, eight with no heat at all.

THE TYPE

Set in Fraunces, drawn by Phaedra Charles and Flavia Zimbardi, and Inter, drawn by Rasmus Andersson. Both are open source.

THE NUMBERS

Nutrition figures are estimates for a quarter of the finished dish, rounded, and exclude anything listed under “bulk it out”. Cook the food, not the numbers.